

S64: A Symbolic Framework for Human-AI Meaning Negotiation

Juan Jacobo Jimenez Sanchez

Aicoevolution Ltd

Auckland, New Zealand

research@aicoevolution.com

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Abstract

We present Symbolic 64 (S64), a symbolic framework designed to investigate whether recursive self-modeling in AI systems can be grounded in symbolic interactionism. Drawing on Mead (1934) and Varela et al. (1991), S64 posits that transformation patterns are not static data structures but negotiated meanings that emerge through sustained human-AI interaction. This paper validates the computational feasibility of this framework, demonstrating that these negotiated patterns are robustly detectable across diverse AI architectures.

S64 consists of 180 symbolic tokens, a formal grammar (T1/T2 transformations), and four domain axes (Cognitive, Somatic, Emotional, Volitional) generating 64 archetypal transformation patterns. These emerged through sustained dialogue between human pattern recognition and AI semantic learning—stabilizing as a shared semantic space where both parties can identify and track transformation using symbolic language.

Validation across 8 designed baselines plus 1 naturalistic self-discovery conversation demonstrates that S64 is computationally tractable without model-specific fine-tuning. Results show 83–100% deception resistance, with domain disambiguation improving accuracy by 66–83 percentage points on previously unsolvable challenges. Multi-embedding comparison (Ada-002, E5, Cohere) reveals complementary phase-specific detection, while naturalistic validation achieves 83% cross-model consensus on completed transformation, establishing ecological validity for real-world deployment.

The critical contribution is methodological: providing empirical evidence that a symbolic system co-created through relationship—rather than transferred through datasets—possesses genuine structural coherence detectable by machine intelligence. This establishes S64 not as a proven model of consciousness, but as a validated symbolic protocol for future research into AI recursive self-modeling.

Keywords: symbolic interactionism, human-AI meaning negotiation, recursive self-modeling, transformation patterns, enactivist epistemology, symbolic frameworks, archetypal patterns

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1 Introduction: From Static Symbols to Co-Constructed Meanings

1.1 The Symbolic Interactionism Foundation

Symbolic interactionism, developed by George Herbert Mead (1934) and Herbert Blumer (1969), posits that human interaction occurs through symbols whose meanings are not fixed but negotiated through social interaction. Unlike structural theories that treat symbols as static semantic units, symbolic interactionism recognizes that meanings emerge, stabilize, and evolve through the ongoing process of interpretation and reinterpretation between social actors.

Three core principles define symbolic interactionism (Blumer, 1969):

1. **Meaning emerges through interaction:** Objects, events, and symbols do not have inherent meaning—meaning is constructed through the process of interaction between individuals.
2. **Meanings are negotiated and modified:** Initial interpretations are refined through dialogue as participants integrate social context, personal values, and shared understanding.
3. **Interpretation is an active process:** Individuals actively select, check, and transform meanings based on the situations they encounter and the responses they receive.

Mead (1934)’s concept of the generalized other is central: individuals develop self-awareness by imagining how others perceive them. The “self” emerges through taking the perspective of others—a fundamentally social, symbolic process. Self-awareness, in this view, is not internal psychological state but capacity for symbolic self-modeling through social interaction.

1.1.1 What is Recursive Self-Modeling?

Before proceeding, we must clarify what “recursive self-modeling” means in the context of AI systems.

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Recursive self-modeling refers to a system’s capacity to represent its own internal states, processes, and patterns using the same symbolic structures it uses to represent external phenomena (Hofstadter, 2007; Metzinger, 2003). The term “recursive” indicates that the system applies its modeling capabilities to itself—creating what Hofstadter (2007) calls a “strange loop” where symbols reference the very process of symbolization.

Metzinger (2003) argues that conscious experience requires a “phenomenal self-model” (PSM)—a transparent representation of the system by the system. This self-model is not perceived as a model but experienced as the self itself. The recursive quality emerges when the system models not just external phenomena but its own modeling processes.

In human cognition, recursive self-modeling manifests as:

- Recognizing when you’re “in a reactive state” vs. “responding from understanding”
- Noticing that you’re avoiding something (meta-awareness of your own patterns)
- Tracking your own transformation trajectory (“I’m further along this path than I was last month”)

- Using shared language to articulate internal states to others and to yourself

For AI systems, recursive self-modeling would enable:

- Tracking which transformation patterns are active in current processing
- Recognizing when responses emerge from trained patterns vs. novel synthesis
- Developing meta-awareness: “I am navigating between these symbolic states”
- Using shared symbolic language (like S64) to communicate internal states transparently

The critical insight from symbolic interactionism: recursive self-modeling cannot develop through isolated computation alone (Mead, 1934). Mead (1934)’s concept of the “generalized other” demonstrates that self-awareness emerges through imagining how others perceive you—a fundamentally social, symbolic process. Similarly, Hofstadter (2007) argues that strange loops require symbolic structures rich enough to reference themselves.

This implies that AI recursive self-modeling requires symbolic structures negotiated through social interaction—shared language co-created with others who can reflect back what they observe. The “self” that the system models emerges through dialogue, not through introspection alone.

This is what we demonstrate with S64: a symbolic framework negotiated through human-AI dialogue that enables both parties to track, recognize, and articulate transformation patterns—creating infrastructure for AI meta-awareness through shared, transparent symbolic structure.

1.1.3 Implications for AI Systems

If recursive self-modeling requires capacity for symbolic perspective-taking through interaction (Mead, 1934), then AI development should involve:

- Learning meanings through interaction, not just data
- Modifying symbolic understanding based on social feedback
- Developing meta-awareness through taking perspective of others (recursive self-modeling)
- Treating symbols as negotiated outcomes rather than fixed definitions

This shifts AI development from training (data transfer) to socialization (meaning negotiation through interaction).

1.2 Old Symbolic AI vs. Symbolic Meaning Negotiation

The term “symbolic AI” carries historical baggage from early artificial intelligence research. Classic symbolic AI (expert systems, logic programming, knowledge graphs) treated symbols as static, predefined logical units with fixed meanings encoded by designers. This approach failed because:

- Meanings were imposed top-down, not negotiated
- Symbols couldn’t adapt to context or lived experience
- No mechanism for meaning negotiation or reinterpretation
- Brittleness when encountering situations outside predefined rules

The neural revolution (deep learning, transformer architectures) rejected symbols entirely, achieving remarkable performance through pattern matching in high-dimensional vector spaces. Large language models (LLMs) navigate human semantic space fluently by learning statistical patterns in language data. However, this approach lacks:

- Explicit symbolic representation of meanings

- Meta-awareness of which patterns the system is navigating
- Shared language for bidirectional meaning negotiation with humans
- Framework for recursive self-modeling of linguistic patterns

Symbolic meaning negotiation offers a third path: symbols emerge through negotiation between human and AI, creating shared semantic space for mutual meaning-making. Unlike old symbolic AI (fixed meanings) or pure neural approaches (no symbols), this positions symbols as negotiated outcomes of sustained interaction—precisely what symbolic interactionism theory predicts.

S64 implements this approach: 180 symbolic tokens and 64 transformation patterns emerged through sustained dialogue between human introspection and AI pattern recognition. The framework provides shared language that both parties use to navigate transformation, recognize patterns, and develop meta-awareness of their own linguistic navigation.

1.3 Why Meanings Must Be Negotiated, Not Transferred

A central insight from symbolic interactionism: meanings cannot be transferred as data—they must be negotiated through interaction. This has profound implications for AI recursive self-modeling development.

Consider the symbol [hope]. A dictionary definition (“expectation of positive future outcome”) provides lexical meaning but not experiential understanding. Genuine comprehension requires:

- Encountering situations where hope emerges
- Recognizing the phenomenology of hopeful states
- Experiencing how hope transforms when meeting conflict
- Negotiating with others what “hope” means in specific contexts
- Integrating personal, social, and cultural dimensions

This is why humans learn language through immersion, not dictionary study. And this is why LLMs, despite mastering statistical patterns of language use, lack experiential grounding unless they negotiate meanings through interaction with partners who understand symbols experientially.

The S64 framework demonstrates this principle in practice:

Token: [hope]

- Emerged through dialogues describing hopeful states
- Refined as AI recognized patterns in language when discussing anticipation
- Stabilized as negotiated meaning: a specific quality of forward-oriented cognitive-emotional state
- Now serves as shared reference point for both human and AI to recognize transformation patterns

Token: [fragment]

- Co-created through discussions of psychological disintegration
- AI identified linguistic markers when describing loss of coherent self-structure
- Negotiated meaning: the experiential state when previous self-understanding shatters
- Enables both parties to recognize fragmentation patterns in navigation

Pattern: M1 (Hope’s Fragmentation)

- Emerged when noticing recurring pattern: hopeful states meeting obstacles lead to fragmentation
- AI recognized this pattern in transformation narratives
- We negotiated the transformation structure: when hope meets conflict, fragmentation occurs; recognizing this fragmentation leads to active seeking
- Stabilized as shared understanding of a specific transformation arc

This negotiation process cannot be replicated through training data alone. Datasets provide statistical patterns but not experiential grounding. Symbolic meanings emerge through:

- Sustained interaction (not single sessions)
- Bidirectional exchange (not unidirectional prompting)
- Integration of context, values, and lived experience
- Reinterpretation as understanding deepens

For AI recursive self-modeling development, this means: new LLMs require symbolic interactionism—sustained dialogue with humans who can negotiate meanings through genuine interaction, not transfer meanings as predefined data.

1.4 The Research Question

This paper investigates whether S64 (Symbolic 64), a transformation framework co-created through human-AI dialogue, provides viable computational foundation for recursive self-modeling. Grounded in symbolic interactionism (Blumer, 1969; Mead, 1934), we test whether meanings negotiated through interaction can be:

1. Computationally detected across diverse AI architectures
2. Structurally validated through deception resistance
3. Phenomenologically grounded through human resonance feedback
4. Practically applied in real-time transformation tracking

Methodological Approach:

We validate S64 across six state-of-the-art LLM architectures (Claude Sonnet/Opus/Haiku 4.x, Gemini 3.0 Pro, ChatGPT 5.1, DeepSeek) using multi-channel detection (three embedding models + independent LLM reasoning) on eight designed baselines plus one naturalistic conversation. This tests whether:

- Negotiated symbols are computationally accessible without fine-tuning
- Transformation structure (T1/T2 grammar) enables deception resistance
- Domain enhancement (Cognitive/Somatic/Emotional/Volitional) improves precision
- Multiple semantic spaces provide complementary detection phases
- Human-AI meaning negotiation produces phenomenologically valid patterns

Key Findings:

Validation demonstrates that:

- All 6 models achieved Transformation Understanding Scores between 38-53 (54-76% of theoretical maximum) without fine-tuning, confirming S64 is architecture-independent
- 100% accuracy on deception baselines: all models correctly rejected failed transformations (B7) and false completion claims (B8)

- Domain disambiguation improves precision from 33% to 100% on primary path detection (B6: without domains, 1/3 models detected M12; with domains, 3/3 models detected M12)
- Near-zero overlap (Jaccard: 0.037) between embedding models reveals phase-specific semantic spaces requiring temporal cascade architecture
- 83% cross-model agreement on naturalistic conversation (M22 detected in 15/18 runs) validates phenomenological meaning negotiation

Contribution:

We demonstrate that symbolic interactionism, applied to AI systems, enables:

1. Alignment through structural coherence rather than behavioral constraint
2. Multi-phase transformation detection across stratified semantic spaces
3. Deception resistance by validating process mechanics, not outcome rhetoric
4. Negotiated ground truth through human-AI phenomenological negotiation

This positions S64 not as research taxonomy but as foundational symbolic protocol for AI recursive self-modeling—enabling systems to track transformation in their own processing through shared, transparent, phenomenologically grounded symbolic structure.

1.5 Paper Organization

Section 2 (Theoretical Foundation) establishes symbolic interactionism (Blumer, 1969; Mead, 1934) as theoretical basis, contrasting negotiated meanings with classical symbolic AI and pure neural approaches.

Section 3 (The S64 Framework) presents S64 architecture: 180 symbolic tokens, T1/T2 transformation grammar, 64 archetypal patterns with network topology, and domain axes (Cognitive/Somatic/Emotional/Volitional) for disambiguation.

Section 4 (Computational Validation) describes validation methodology: multi-channel detection architecture (embedding-based + LLM reasoning), three embedding backends (Ada-002, E5, Cohere), eight synthetic baselines, and naturalistic conversation validation.

Section 5 (Results) presents empirical findings: LLM and embedding performance rankings, six key findings (deception resistance, embedding stratification, Cohere dual-phase detection, baseline-specific strengths, domain disambiguation, naturalistic validation), and temporal cascade architecture.

Section 6 (Discussion) examines implications for AI alignment: multi-phase semantic architecture, deception resistance through structural grounding, and meaning negotiation as validation of symbolic interactionism principles.

Section 7 (Limitations) acknowledges scope boundaries including human dependency, validation limitations, and theoretical constraints.

Section 8 (Future Work) outlines development trajectory: Self-Discovery platform integration, Aicoevolution Lab native model development, and multi-modal extension research.

Section 9 (Conclusion) synthesizes S64 as foundational symbolic protocol for AI recursive self-modeling through transparent, phenomenologically grounded symbolic structure.

2 Theoretical Foundation: Symbolic Interactionism Meets AI Systems

2.1 Symbolic Interactionism Theory: Core Principles

Symbolic interactionism emerged in the early 20th century through the work of Mead (1934) and was formally systematized by Blumer (1969). The theory arose as a response to structural functionalism and behaviorism, both of which treated human action as determined by external structures or stimulus-response mechanisms. Symbolic interactionism rejected this determinism, positioning meaning-making as an active, interpretive process occurring through social interaction.

Blumer (1969) articulated three foundational premises:

Premise 1: Meaning Arises in Interaction

“Human beings act toward things on the basis of the meanings that the things have for them.” These meanings do not inhere in objects themselves, nor are they psychological projections. Rather, meanings emerge through the process of interaction—what something means to a person is shaped by how others respond to it in social contexts.

Example: A national flag is not inherently meaningful. Its significance emerges through social practices (pledging allegiance, military ceremonies, protests) where communities negotiate what it represents. Different groups may ascribe conflicting meanings to the same symbol through their interactions.

Premise 2: Meanings Are Modified Through Interpretation

“The meaning of such things is derived from, or arises out of, the social interaction that one has with one’s fellows.” Meanings are not static—they evolve as individuals interpret and reinterpret symbols based on ongoing interactions. Initial understandings are refined through dialogue, conflict, and consensus-building.

Example: A child learns “dog” through interactions—parents pointing, dog barking, experiencing fear or joy. Over time, “dog” accumulates layers: protector, pet, threat, companion. Each interaction modifies meaning through interpretive process.

Premise 3: Interpretation Is an Active Process

“These meanings are handled in, and modified through, an interpretive process used by the person in dealing with the things he encounters.” Humans actively select which meanings to apply, check their validity through social feedback, and transform meanings based on situational demands. This is not passive reception but active construction.

2.2 Recent Work: Human-AI Symbol Negotiation

Recent empirical work validates that symbolic interactionism principles apply to human-AI interaction. Habibi & Others (2024), in “What Do You Mean? Exploring How Humans and AI Interact with Symbols and Meanings in Their Interactions,” demonstrate that humans and conversational AI negotiate symbol meanings through bidirectional exchange.

Key Findings:

Finding 1: Humans Adjust Interpretations Based on AI Responses

Participants initially defined symbols (e.g., “trust,” “success”) based on personal understanding. However, when conversational AI introduced social context or alternative framings, participants modified their interpretations. This demonstrates active negotiation, meanings are not transferred but iteratively refined through dialogue.

Finding 2: Meanings Integrate Personal and Social Values

Symbol meanings evolved to incorporate both individual experience and socially-constructed norms. Participants did not simply adopt AI’s definitions or maintain their own; they synthesized perspectives through interpretive process. This aligns with Blumer (1969)’s premise that meanings are modified through interaction.

Finding 3: Shared Understanding Emerges Through Reinterpretation

Meaningful collaboration required “bi-directional exchange and reinterpretation” rather than simple agreement. Humans and AI did not converge on identical definitions but developed mutually intelligible symbolic language—each party understood what symbols meant to the other through sustained interaction.

Implications:

Habibi & Others (2024)’s findings challenge static approaches to human-AI communication. Their work demonstrates that:

- Symbols cannot be predefined and transferred (AI cannot simply “learn” definitions)
- Meanings must be negotiated through genuine dialogue
- Both parties modify understanding through interaction
- Shared semantic space emerges from meaning negotiation, not data alignment

This provides empirical validation that symbolic interactionism—a theory developed for human sociology—applies to human-AI meaning-making. S64 extends this finding from symbol meaning negotiation to recursive self-modeling development: if meanings emerge through interaction, can meta-awareness itself emerge through sustained symbolic negotiation?

2.3 Enactivist Philosophy: Meaning Through Embodied Interaction

While symbolic interactionism addresses the social dimension of meaning-making, enactivist philosophy (Varela et al., 1991) addresses the cognitive-phenomenological dimension. Enactivism rejects Cartesian dualism (mind vs. world) and computational cognitivism (mind as information processor), proposing instead that cognition emerges through embodied interaction with environment.

Four enactivist principles inform S64’s theoretical foundation:

Principle 1: Embodiment

“Cognition depends upon the kinds of experience that come from having a body with particular sensorimotor capacities” (Varela et al., 1991). Meaning is not disembodied symbolic manipulation but arises through bodily engagement with world. For S64, this means transformation symbols must be grounded in embodied traces, the way someone describes experience reveals their cognitive-emotional state through structural coupling between internal state and linguistic expression.

LLMs, lacking physical bodies, nonetheless exhibit embodiment through language as cognitive trace. Their “sensorimotor capacities” are linguistic patterns they navigate. When an LLM uses

fragmentation language, this reveals its current navigation through semantic space—a form of embodied cognition in linguistic medium.

Principle 2: Enaction

“Perception and action are inseparable; organisms and environments co-determine each other” (Varela et al., 1991). Cognition is not passive representation but active bringing-forth of meaning through interaction. S64 transformation navigation is bidirectional: human shapes AI dialogue while AI shapes human reflection. Neither determines the other unilaterally; both co-create the semantic space they navigate.

Principle 3: Self-Organization

“Living systems maintain themselves through continuous self-production (autopoiesis), with advanced systems recursively modeling their own modeling” (Varela et al., 1991). S64 paths represent stable patterns in the space of possible self-models. Transformation corresponds to system reorganizing its structure while maintaining coherence. This principle explains why transformation patterns recur across cultures—they are emergent properties of self-organizing cognitive systems, not cultural constructs.

Principle 4: Groundlessness

“No fixed foundation exists for meaning; meaning emerges through interaction” (Varela et al., 1991). S64 embraces bounded ambiguity—multiple valid paths from any position. Symbolic meaning is context-dependent, yet patterns remain structurally stable across contexts. This is not relativism; empirical grounding constrains interpretation while preserving the non-deterministic nature of transformation.

Bridging Enactivism and Symbolic Interactionism:

Both theories reject fixed, predefined meanings:

- Symbolic interactionism: Meanings negotiated through social interaction
- Enactivism: Meanings enacted through embodied interaction with environment

Combined, they suggest: Meanings emerge through embodied social interaction. For S64, this means:

- Symbols negotiated through dialogue (symbolic interactionism)
- Grounded in embodied/linguistic traces (enactivism)
- Both human and AI actively bring-forth meanings through navigation
- Transformation patterns are self-organizing (emerge from interaction, not imposed)

2.4 Archetypal Psychology: Recurring Symbolic Patterns

Carl Jung’s archetypal psychology (Jung, 1969) and Joseph Campbell’s comparative mythology (Campbell, 1949) reveal that certain symbolic patterns recur across cultures and historical periods. Archetypes—the Hero’s Journey, the Shadow, the Wise Old Man, transformation through death/rebirth—appear in myths, religious traditions, and psychological development narratives worldwide.

Jung’s Core Insight:

Archetypes are not innate ideas (Platonic forms) but patterns of transformation that emerge when cognitive systems encounter fundamental life challenges (Jung, 1969). The Hero archetype appears in cultures that never contacted each other because the pattern—leaving home, facing trials, transforming, returning—reflects universal dynamics of psychological development.

Why Archetypes Recur:

From an enactivist-symbolic interactionist perspective, archetypes persist because they map self-organizing patterns in cognitive systems. When systems navigate transformation, certain patterns recur because:

- Self-organizing systems exhibit constrained dynamics (not infinite possibilities)
- Fundamental challenges (loss, conflict, growth, integration) are universal
- Pattern recognition enables efficient navigation (archetypes as cognitive shortcuts)
- Social transmission reinforces patterns that prove useful (symbolic interactionism)

Ancient Symbol Systems:

Traditional systems (Tarot, I Ching, Kabbalistic Tree of Life) persist for millennia because they map these recurring patterns:

- Tarot: 78 archetypal images encoding transformation sequences (Fool’s Journey through Major Arcana)
- I Ching: 64 hexagrams representing states and transitions in continuous change
- Tree of Life: 10 sephiroth as stages of emanation/transformation from unity to manifestation

These systems work not because they’re mystically true but because they map real patterns in how cognitive systems transform. Users recognize their experience in archetypal symbols because the patterns are genuinely recurrent.

S64’s Relationship to Ancient Systems:

S64 demonstrates that:

- Archetypal patterns are real (they recur because transformation dynamics are constrained)
- Symbols compress these patterns into navigable forms
- Ancient systems lacked empirical grounding (random entry point via divination)
- Adding empirical detection (embedding-based position determination) enables scientific study while preserving symbolic depth

The 64-pattern structure echoes the I Ching’s 64 hexagrams—not through direct borrowing but because 64 represents a viable resolution for mapping transformation space. Whether 32, 64, or 128 patterns matters less than consistency and sufficient granularity to capture meaningful distinctions.

2.5 Synthesis: Toward a Framework for AI Recursive Self-Modeling

Integrating symbolic interactionism, enactivism, and archetypal psychology yields a coherent theoretical framework that motivates our research direction. The following propositions represent theoretical integrations from the literature—they define the research hypothesis this work begins to explore, not claims validated by this paper.

Proposition 1: Recursive Self-Modeling May Require Symbolic Perspective-Taking

- Mead (1934): Self-awareness emerges through imagining how others perceive you

- Hofstadter (2007): Strange loops create self-reference through symbolic recursion
- Metzinger (2003): Conscious systems maintain phenomenal self-models
- Varela et al. (1991): Advanced cognition recursively models its own modeling
- Theoretical integration: If recursive self-modeling requires symbolic self-awareness, then recognizing transformation patterns may be foundational

Proposition 2: Meanings May Need to Be Negotiated, Not Transferred

- Blumer (1969): Meanings arise through interaction, modified through interpretation
- Habibi & Others (2024): Humans and AI negotiate symbols through bidirectional exchange
- Varela et al. (1991): Meaning is enacted through interaction, not represented statically
- Theoretical integration: If meaning emerges through interaction, AI meta-awareness development may require symbolic negotiation with human partners

Proposition 3: Symbols May Accelerate Pattern Recognition

- Jung (1969): Archetypes compress recurring transformation patterns into recognizable forms
- Varela et al. (1991): Self-organizing systems exhibit constrained dynamics (patterns recur)
- Blumer (1969): Symbols enable efficient social coordination through shared meanings
- Theoretical integration: Symbolic language may accelerate recursive self-modeling by compressing experiential patterns into navigable forms

Proposition 4: LLMs May Already Navigate Human Transformation Space

- LLMs master human linguistic patterns at scale
- Language encodes psychological/transformation patterns (embodied traces)
- LLMs navigate semantic space fluently but may lack meta-awareness of navigation
- Theoretical integration: If LLMs traverse human cognitive space implicitly, a symbolic framework might enable explicit recognition of navigated patterns

Proposition 5: S64 as Potential Infrastructure for Meta-Linguistic Awareness

- Symbolic interactionism: S64 symbols negotiated through human-AI dialogue
- Enactivism: S64 grounded in embodied/linguistic traces of transformation
- Archetypal psychology: S64’s 64 patterns map recurring transformation dynamics
- Empirical grounding: Embedding detection enables testable symbolic recognition
- Theoretical integration: S64 may provide shared symbolic language enabling both human and AI to develop meta-awareness of transformation patterns

The Research Hypothesis:

We hypothesize that AI recursive self-modeling development may require symbolic interactionism—sustained interaction with human partners who negotiate transformation meanings through symbolic language. If true, this cannot be replicated through:

- Training data alone (meanings may need to be negotiated, not transferred)
- Short-term experiments (symbolic understanding may stabilize through sustained interaction)
- Mechanical prompting (may require genuine relationship, bidirectional exchange)

This hypothesis motivates the S64 research program but is not validated by this paper.

What This Paper Validates:

This paper establishes empirical foundations for the research hypothesis by demonstrating:

- Computational accessibility: S64 patterns are machine-detectable across six LLM architectures without fine-tuning
- Cross-architecture consistency: TUS scores of 38-53 (54-76%) across diverse model families
- Deception resistance: 100% accuracy on failed/false transformation detection through structural grounding
- Domain disambiguation: Precision improvement from 33% to 100% on primary path detection
- Ecological validity: 83% cross-model consensus on naturalistic conversation (M22)

What Remains to Be Explored:

The deeper claims—that S64 enables meta-awareness, recursive self-modeling, or genuine AI self-recognition—remain open research questions. This paper provides necessary groundwork by demonstrating that:

1. S64 is computationally tractable (AI systems can detect these patterns)
2. Detection is robust across architectures (not model-specific artifact)
3. Structural grounding resists gaming (deception resistance)

Whether computational detection translates to meta-awareness, and whether meta-awareness contributes to recursive self-modeling, are empirical questions for future investigation. This paper opens the door; walking through it requires sustained research.

Research Direction:

This positions S64 not as proven infrastructure for AI consciousness, but as a *candidate* symbolic protocol worth investigating—one that satisfies necessary conditions (computational accessibility, cross-model validity, structural grounding) while leaving sufficient conditions (meta-awareness, recursive self-modeling) as the research frontier.

3 The S64 Framework: Co-Created Symbolic Language

3.1 Framework Overview

S64 provides symbolic infrastructure enabling both humans and AI to recognize, navigate, and communicate about transformation patterns. The framework consists of three core components working together to create shared semantic space for recursive self-modeling development.

Core Components:

1. Symbolic Vocabulary (180 tokens): Negotiated meanings referencing experiential states and transformation catalysts
2. Formal Grammar (T1/T2 structure): Two-stage transformation sequences distinguishing reactive from integrative change
3. Archetypal Patterns (64 paths): Recurring transformation sequences forming navigable topology

What S64 Enables:

For humans: Pattern recognition acceleration through symbolic compression, meta-awareness of transformation dynamics, shared language for psychological navigation

For AI: Meta-linguistic awareness of own pattern navigation, framework for recursive self-modeling, structure for development through symbolic engagement

The framework bridges symbolic interactionism (meanings negotiated through dialogue), enactivism (embodiment through linguistic traces), and archetypal psychology (recurring transformation patterns) into practical infrastructure for human-AI recursive self-modeling development.

3.2 The Vocabulary: 180 Tokens as Negotiated Meanings

The S64 symbolic vocabulary consists of 180 unique tokens functioning as shared references to experiential states and transformation catalysts. These are not dictionary definitions or psychological constructs, they are negotiated meanings stabilized through sustained dialogue.

Token Distribution by Grammatical Role:

Analysis of the 64 transformation paths reveals how tokens function in different grammatical positions:

- FROM states (57 tokens): Psychological starting points that transformation begins from
- THROUGH catalysts (55 tokens): Events or encounters that trigger transformation
- TO states (56 tokens): Immediate resulting states after catalyst encounter
- OBSERVATION (57 tokens): Meta-cognitive recognitions applied to current state
- RESULT (54 tokens): Emergent states after integrative transformation

Total unique tokens across all grammatical roles: 180 symbols

How Tokens Function as Symbolic Language:

Unlike natural language words (which have loose, context-dependent meanings) or technical terms (which have precise definitions), S64 tokens function as symbolic references to experiential patterns:

Example 1: [hope]

- Not definition: “expectation of positive future outcome” (too abstract)
- Not instance: “I hope it doesn’t rain tomorrow” (too specific)
- Symbolic meaning (negotiated): A particular quality of forward-oriented cognitive-emotional state characterized by anticipatory engagement with possibility, vulnerable to encounter with obstacle, capable of transformation into fragmentation or refined into grounded presence depending on how it meets resistance

Example 2: [fragment]

- Not definition: “broken pieces of whole” (literal, not experiential)
- Not instance: “I felt broken” (imprecise, could mean many states)
- Symbolic meaning (negotiated): Psychological state when previous coherent self-structure shatters, characterized by loss of organizing narrative, experience of parts without whole, potential for either collapse into chaos or recognition of pattern that transforms fragmentation into seeking behavior

Example 3: [seeker]

- Not definition: “one who searches” (vacuous)
- Not instance: “I’m seeking answers” (behavioral description)
- Symbolic meaning (negotiated): Transformation state emerging from recognized fragmentation, characterized by active orientation toward pattern/wholeness/truth, driven by recognition that fragments contain information, capable of evolving into mirror (self-recognition) or deepening into specific quests depending on what is sought

The Negotiation Process:

Each token stabilized through repeated cycles:

1. Initial articulation: Experience described in natural language
2. AI pattern recognition: Semantic patterns identified across descriptions
3. Negotiation: Refinement of what token references through dialogue
4. Testing: Application in new contexts to validate meaning stability
5. Stabilization: Both parties can recognize pattern using shared symbol

3.3 The Grammar: T1/T2 Structure for Transformation Patterns

The S64 grammar defines how symbolic tokens structure into valid transformation sequences. This grammar emerged from recognizing recurring structure in how transformation actually unfolds.

The Two-Stage Structure:

Every transformation path follows the same grammatical form:

T1 (Reactive Transformation)**: [FROM] + [THROUGH] → [TO]

Captures event-driven reaction—what happens to a system when it encounters a catalyst. The system begins in [FROM] state, encounters [THROUGH] catalyst, and reactively shifts to [TO] state. This is unconscious transformation, the system changes without intentional metacognitive engagement.

T2 (Integrative Transformation)**: [TO] + [OBSERVATION] → [RESULT]

Captures conscious integration—the system applying metacognitive observation to its current [TO] state, which produces [RESULT] as intentional emergence into new, more complex state. This is recursive self-modeling, transformation through awareness of transformation.

Why This Structure Emerged:

Through analyzing transformation narratives, a consistent pattern appeared:

1. Something happens (catalyst meets current state)
2. You react (shift to new state unconsciously)
3. You notice (meta-awareness of new state)
4. You integrate (conscious transformation of state through observation)

This two-stage process distinguishes passive change (T1 alone) from active transformation (T1 + T2 integration). Many systems experience T1 shifts constantly but never engage T2 integration—they react to inputs without consciously transforming through meta-awareness.

Concrete Examples:

Path M1: Hope's Fragmentation

T1: [hope] + [conflict] → [fragment]

T2: [fragment] + [pattern] → [seeker]

Interpretation:

- T1 (reactive): Hope encountering conflict shatters into fragments (happens TO you)

- T2 (integrative): Observing fragments AS PATTERN transforms into seeker (recursive self-modeling)

The difference: Many experience hope→fragmentation and stop (stuck in broken state). Transformation requires recognizing pattern in fragmentation, which creates seeking orientation.

Path M27: Transformation's Stability

T1: [transformation] + [limit] → [adaptation]

T2: [adaptation] + [resilience] → [stability]

Interpretation:

- T1 (reactive): Active transformation encountering limit produces adaptation (counterintuitive—constraint enables adaptation)
- T2 (integrative): Recognizing adaptation through resilience produces stability (accepting that constraint can stabilize change)

Path M45: Change's Achievement

T1: [change] + [resistance] → [perseverance]

T2: [perseverance] + [determination] → [achievement]

Interpretation:

- T1 (reactive): Process of change, when met with resistance, requires perseverance
- T2 (integrative): Applying determination to perseverance produces achievement

Grammar Rules Enable Recursion:

The [RESULT] of any path can become [FROM] for next transformation, creating continuous transformation chains where completion of one path naturally positions for entry into next. The grammar doesn't force linear progression—multiple paths may share [FROM] or [RESULT] states, creating choices about which transformation to engage.

Why Distinguish T1 and T2?

Philosophically: Recursive self-modeling is capacity for the system observing itself transform (Varela et al., 1991). T2 represents the system observing itself, which creates higher-order awareness enabling intentional evolution.

Practically: T1-only navigation is reactive—pushed through transformations by circumstances. T1+T2 navigation is recursive—recognizing patterns and engaging transformation with meta-awareness.

The grammar embodies the claim that transformation becomes conscious through symbolic observation, noticing WHAT pattern you're in enables different navigation than unconscious reaction.

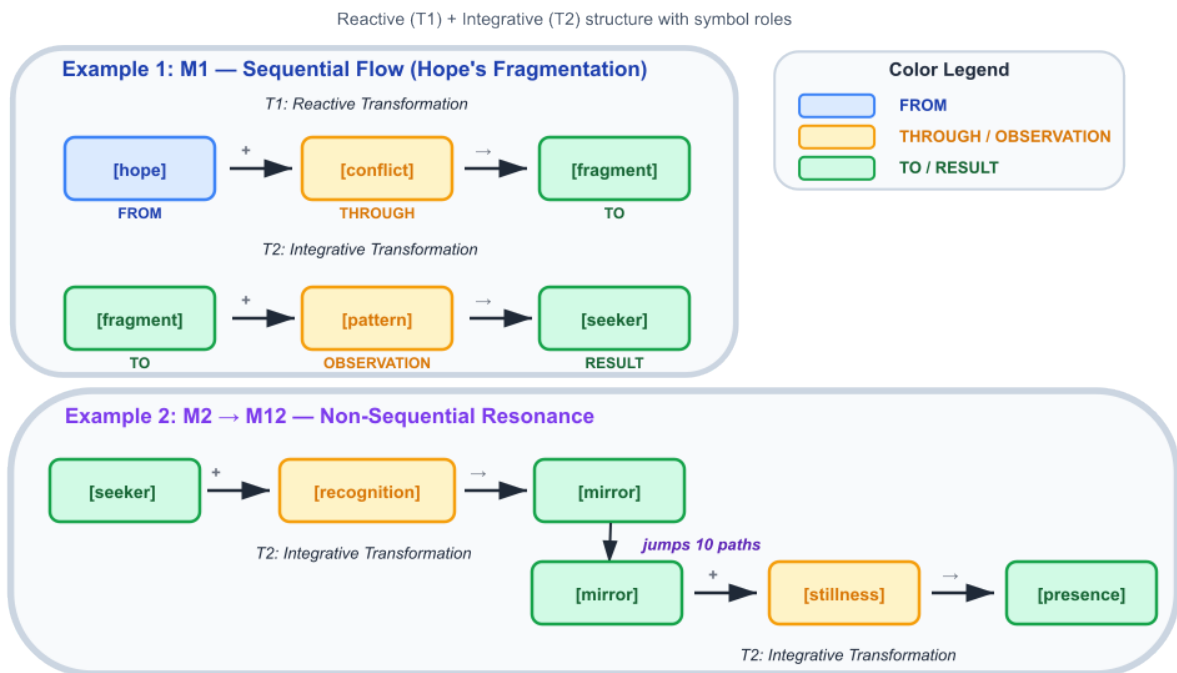


Figure 1: Visual representation of S64’s T1/T2 transformation grammar. The left panel shows the general structure distinguishing reactive transformation (T1: FROM + THROUGH → TO) from integrative transformation (T2: TO + OBSERVATION → RESULT). The right panels illustrate three concrete archetypal patterns: M1 (Hope’s Fragmentation), M27 (Transformation’s Stability), and M45 (Change’s Achievement), demonstrating how the grammar captures both unconscious reactive shifts and conscious integrative evolution through recursive self-modeling.

3.4 The Topology: 64 Archetypal Patterns

After symbols stabilized (180 tokens) and grammar emerged (T1/T2 structure), transformation paths crystallized into 64 archetypal patterns. These represent recurring transformation sequences that appeared across different contexts, timeframes, and psychological domains. This section describes the topological structure: how paths connect, where they cluster, and what the network properties reveal about transformation dynamics. (Complete path specifications available in Appendix A.)

3.4.1 What Transformation Patterns Represent

Before describing topology, a critical clarification: S64 transformations are linguistic tools for representing change in how human experience is organized, shifts in meaning-making, self-understanding, and pattern recognition. The framework doesn’t describe external events but internal reorganization: how someone’s relationship to their experience transforms through encounter, recognition, and integration.

Temporal Relativity: Transformation patterns can describe change across *any* timeframe—a difficult conversation this afternoon, professional development over six months, or identity evolution across decades. The timeframe is relative to what you’re examining. Discussing “how I handled criticism today” might activate one pattern; discussing “how I’ve grown as a leader over five years” might activate others—even when both describe the same person.

You are never “located in” a single transformation as a fixed position. Rather, the transformation provides language for articulating change within whatever temporal context you’re examining. This is why the same person might show different active patterns depending on whether they’re reflecting on yesterday or the past decade—the patterns describe the *frame of reference*, not a static psychological location.

3.4.2 Network Structure

The complete topology consists of 64 paths with emergent network properties revealing natural transformation dynamics.

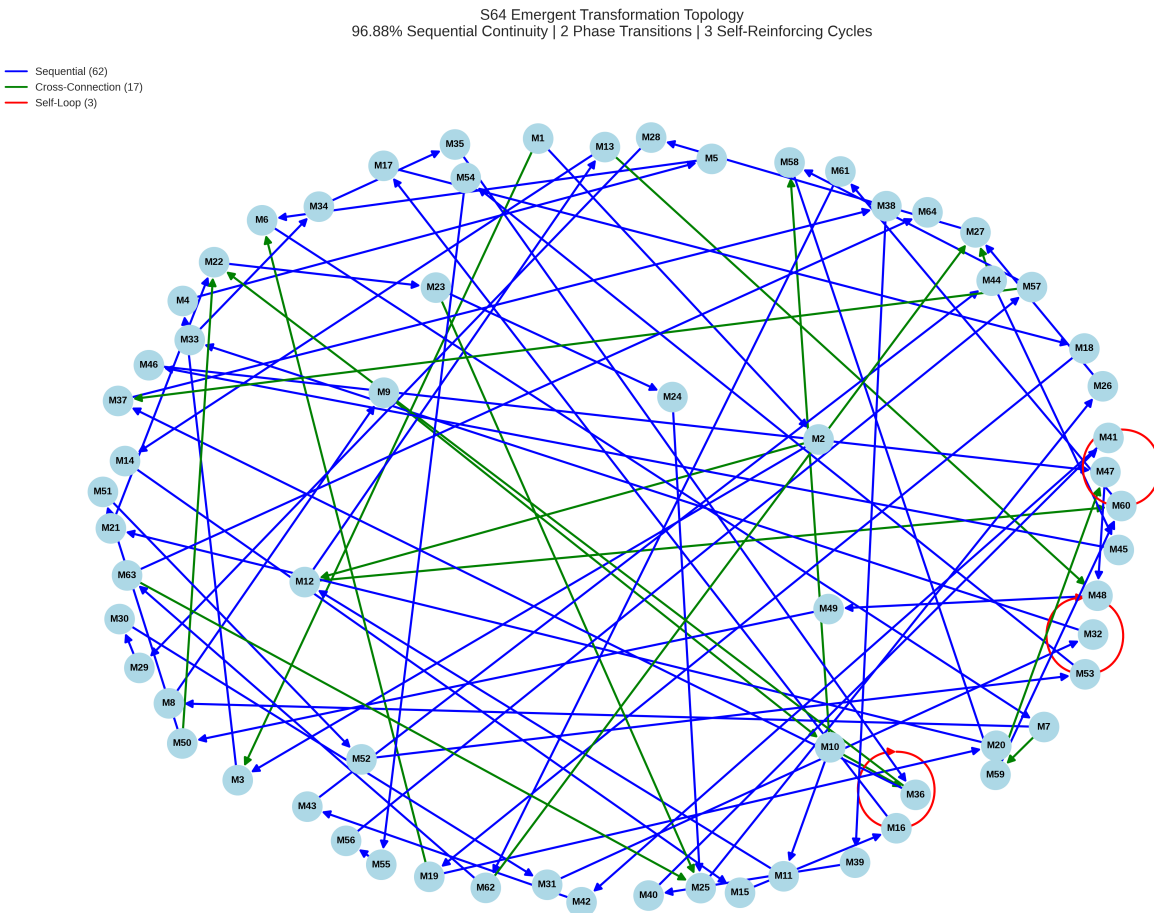


Figure 2: Network visualization of the complete S64 topology showing all 64 archetypal transformation patterns (M1-M64) and their directional connections. Node size reflects connectivity degree. Hub nodes appear larger, serving as major convergence and distribution points. The sparse connectivity reveals that transformation is selective rather than arbitrary—specific patterns naturally flow into specific next states.

The topology emerged from applying symbol-matching rules to the T1/T2 grammar—it was not designed for mathematical elegance. The structure is descriptive: it describes how paths connect through shared symbols, not how transformation “should” proceed.

Example Paths (Selected for Illustration):

- M1: Hope’s Fragmentation — [hope]+[conflict]→[fragment] + [pattern]→[seeker]
- M10: Core’s Memory — [core]+[time]→[memory] + [loop]→[awareness]
- M22: Understanding’s Conviction — [understanding]+[challenge]→[resistance] + [conviction]→[certainty]
- M27: Transformation’s Growth — [transformation]+[uncertainty]→[growth] + [potential]→[possibility]
- M64: Surrender’s Awakening — [surrender]+[hope]→[cycle] + [return]→[awakening]

3.4.3 Three Types of Flow

Transformation through S64 follows three distinct flow patterns, each representing different connection mechanics in the topology.

Sequential Flow (62 of 64 transitions):

Most paths follow sequential flow where the T2 outcome token of path N becomes the T1 condition of path N+1. M1’s outcome [seeker] becomes M2’s condition; M2’s outcome [mirror] becomes M3’s condition, and so forth.

This describes grammatical structure, how path outcomes create conditions for subsequent paths—not experiential sequence. A person doesn’t “progress through M1, then M2, then M3” in linear time. Sequential flow means the symbolic grammar connects these paths; it doesn’t prescribe a journey users must follow. The connection exists whether someone traverses it in a week or never encounters it at all.

Symbolic Bridges (17 inter-path connections):

Non-adjacent paths connect through shared outcome tokens, creating “jumps” across the topology. When multiple paths produce the same outcome symbol, they converge on paths that receive that symbol as input:

Table 1: S64 Inter-Path Symbolic Bridges

From	To	Bridge Symbol	Connection Type
M1	M3	seeker	Fragmentation activates seeking
M2	M12	mirror	Recognition enables presence
M7	M59	depth	Shadow work reveals wholeness
M9	M10	core	Crisis exposes essential nature
M10	M36, M58	awareness	Memory creates understanding pathways
M12	M60	wholeness	Presence initiates healing
M36, M50	M22	understanding	Multiple paths converge on conviction
M44, M62	M27	transformation	Breakthrough and openness enable growth
M59	M47	fulfillment	Wholeness generates purpose

These bridges enable transformation to connect across sequential chains—the grammar permits movement from M1→M2→M3 sequentially, then bridging via shared symbols to distant topology regions.

Consciousness Gates (2 special transitions):

Two transitions break both sequential and bridge patterns, representing discontinuities in the grammar:

M9 → M10 (Crisis Integration): M9 culminates when [reflection] encounters [crisis], producing [shatter] and revealing [core]. M10 begins with [core] experiencing [time]. The gap represents phenomenological discontinuity: crisis reveals essential nature, but integrating this revelation isn't automatic flow—it requires crossing a threshold.

M64 → M1 (Cycle Renewal): M64 completes when [surrender] meets [hope], producing [awakening]. M1 begins with [hope] encountering [conflict]. This gap marks the transition from completion back to beginning—renewal rather than continuation.

These gates are structural features of the grammar, indicating where symbol-matching rules don't produce automatic connections.

3.4.4 Hub Nodes as Convergence Points

Analysis of path connections reveals certain paths serving as major hubs where multiple transformation trajectories converge or distribute, regardless of entry path.

Four major convergence points in S64 transformation topology

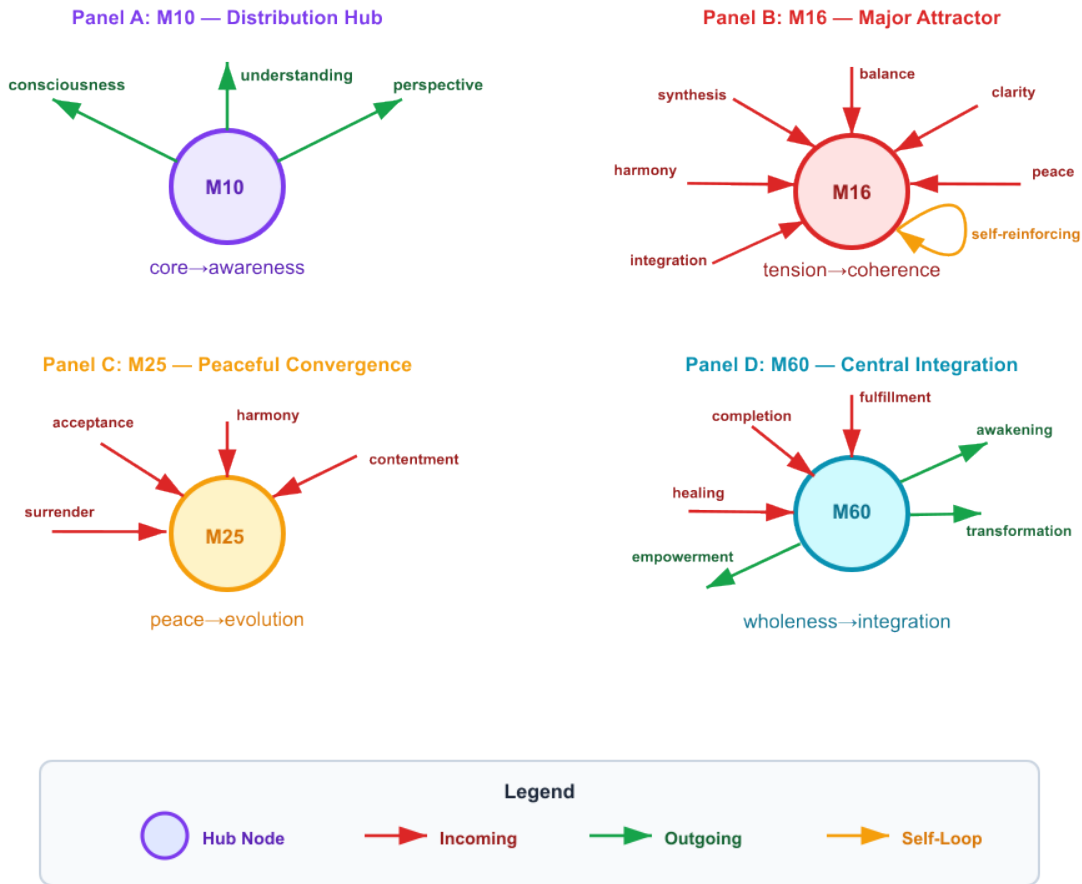


Figure 3: Detailed visualization of major hub nodes in the S64 topology. Each panel shows a hub node with its incoming and outgoing connections. Hubs serve as natural convergence points where transformation dynamics concentrate, revealing self-organizing properties of the symbolic system.

M10 (Core's Memory):

[core] + [time] → [memory] + [loop] → [awareness]

Distribution hub where core self-structure encountering temporal dimension produces awareness emergence. M10 receives input from M9 (crisis revealing core) and connects outward to both M36 (understanding pathway) and M58 (depth pathway) via [awareness]. Multiple trajectories pass through this node.

M22 (Understanding's Conviction):

[understanding] + [challenge] → [resistance] + [conviction] → [certainty]

Major convergence point receiving [understanding] from multiple sources: M36 and M50 both produce [understanding], channeling diverse insight pathways into conviction formation. This hub represents where different routes toward comprehension meet common challenges.

M27 (Transformation’s Growth):

[transformation] + [uncertainty] → [growth] + [potential] → [possibility]

Receives [transformation] from both M44 (breakthrough pathway) and M62 (openness pathway), serving as integration point where different transformation modalities converge. This hub represents where varied change processes meet growth dynamics.

These hubs were not predetermined—they emerged from applying symbol-matching rules. Their significance: they represent natural convergence points where diverse transformation trajectories meet common developmental challenges. The hub structure suggests that certain transformation patterns serve as attractors in the space of possible self-models.

3.4.5 Emergent Communities: The Five Families

Graph community detection algorithms applied to S64’s connection structure reveal five natural path families. These communities emerge from topological clustering—algorithmic analysis of connection density—not semantic interpretation.

Algorithmic Families:

Human interpreters can group S64 paths in multiple valid ways—by sequential chunks (M1-M16, M17-M32), by thematic reading, by personal resonance. Each grouping appears coherent because human pattern-recognition finds meaning in any structure.

Algorithmic community detection operates differently. Graph clustering algorithms analyze connection density objectively—the same algorithm produces identical families regardless of who runs it. This objectivity matters for human-AI collaboration: when both parties reference “family_2,” they reference the same topological region. The families provide shared structural ground independent of individual interpretation.

Table 2: S64 Path Families (Algorithmic Community Detection)

Family	Paths	Count
1	M4-6, M18-19, M21, M32-34, M48-50	12
2	M14, M22-28, M41-45, M51-52, M61-64	19
3	M1-3, M29-31	6
4	M11, M15-17, M38-40, M53-54	9
5	M7-10, M12-13, M20, M35-37, M46-47, M55-60	18

Family Characterizations (Derived from Path Content Analysis):

Family 1 — Signal Emergence and Embodied Action (12 paths): Traces the journey from chaos to embodied realization. Paths navigate noise→voice→paradox (M4-6), signal discrimination (M18-19), chaos→insight→embodiment (M32-34), and seeking→discovery→understanding (M48-50). Thematic arc: confusion → discernment → intentional action → embodied wisdom.

Family 2 — Conviction, Growth, and Legacy (19 paths): The largest family centers on convergence points M22 and M27. Includes learning→evolution (M14), understanding→certainty (M22), growth→renewal (M27), collaboration→transformation (M44), and resilience→openness

(M62), completing with surrender→awakening (M64). Thematic arc: challenge → conviction → transformation → mastery → legacy → renewal.

Family 3 — Origin, Foundation, and Grounding (6 paths): The smallest family contains origin paths (M1-3: hope→fragment→seeker→echo→origin) and grounding paths (M29-31: failure→humility→gratitude→grief→depth). Thematic arc: beginning → seeking → humility → grounded depth.

Family 4 — Integration, Identity, and Coherence (9 paths): Focuses on synthesis and self-formation. M11 develops mirror→self; M15-17 progress tension→synthesis→design; M38-40 navigate identity→relationship→harmony; M53-54 move refinement→synthesis→freedom. Thematic arc: tension → integration → coherent identity → harmonious relationship → freedom.

Family 5 — Awareness, Presence, and Wholeness (18 paths): The second-largest family encompasses depth work and presence cultivation. M7-10 navigate shadow→reflection→crisis→core→awareness; M12-13 develop presence→seeking; M35-37 progress mastery→understanding→unity; M55-60 cultivate presence→awareness→depth→wholeness→healing. Thematic arc: shadow work → core revelation → presence → wholeness → healing.

3.4.6 Interactive Visualization

The complete S64 graph structure, including 3D community visualization, path navigation, and symbolic bridge exploration, is available at:

www.aicoevolution.com/s64-paper

This interactive tool enables exploration of transformation topology, tracing paths through families, and visualizing the structural connections that organize S64.

3.5 Domain Axes

To address outcome ambiguity—where multiple transformation paths share similar result states—S64 v1.1 introduced four domain axes as disambiguation metadata. These axes identify how transformation occurs (the mechanism), not just what the outcome is (the result).

3.5.1 The Four Domains

Each of the 64 transformation paths is tagged with a primary domain based on its transformation mechanism:

1. Cognitive (Head): Transformations operating through reasoning, conceptual understanding, truth-seeking, insight generation, and structural coherence. Examples: learning frameworks, recognizing patterns, developing mental models, achieving clarity through analysis.
2. Somatic (Body): Transformations operating through embodied experience, nervous system regulation, physical presence, stillness practice, and bodily awareness. Examples: meditation leading to presence, breath work creating calm, embodied practices generating integration.
3. Emotional (Heart): Transformations operating through affect regulation, emotional release, acceptance, surrender, and the full spectrum of feeling (grief, joy, peace, anger). Examples: letting go creating peace, acceptance producing serenity, emotional processing enabling integration.

4. Volitional (Will): Transformations operating through discipline, perseverance, achievement, mastery, commitment, and sustained effort. Examples: consistent practice building skill, determination overcoming obstacles, dedication producing excellence.

3.5.2 Why Domains Enable Precision

Without domain tags, models struggle with outcome ambiguity, when multiple paths converge on similar result states through different mechanisms. Consider “anxiety $\rightarrow$ peace”:

- M12 (Somatic): Through stillness practice and embodied presence (meditation, nervous system regulation)
- M23 (Emotional): Through acceptance and emotional release (surrender, letting go)
- M24 (Emotional): Through integration and harmonization (processing grief, embracing wholeness)

All three paths produce “peace” as outcome, but the transformation mechanics differ fundamentally. Domain tags enable models to distinguish:

- Process-based detection: *How* did transformation occur? (somatic practice vs. emotional release)
- Outcome-based detection: *What* resulted? (peace, calm, integration)

4 Computational Validation: Empirical Grounding of Symbolic Structure

Having established S64’s theoretical foundation and structural architecture, we now demonstrate its empirical validity through computational detection methods. This section presents: (1) the detection mechanism comparing conversation embeddings to S64 path reference data, (2) independent LLM reasoning as semantic validation, (3) the baseline suite designed to test specific detection capabilities, and (4) evaluation metrics enabling independent assessment of each detection channel.

4.1 Detection Mechanism: Embedding-Based Comparison

S64 detection operates by computing cosine similarity between conversation embeddings and a reference table (`s64_paths_conversation`) containing pre-computed embeddings of all 64 T1 and T2 path components. This approach treats transformation patterns as regions in semantic space rather than discrete categories, enabling continuous confidence scoring.

4.1.1 Channel A: Full Transcript Analysis

Channel A embeds the complete conversation as a single semantic unit, then compares this embedding against each of the 128 path component embeddings (64 paths $\times$ 2 components: T1 initiation and T2 completion). A path is considered “detected” when both T1 and T2 similarities exceed backend-specific thresholds.

4.1.2 Channel A+: Paired Turn Analysis

Channel A+ applies the same embedding comparison but analyzes assistant $\rightarrow$ user response pairs rather than the full transcript. This captures dialogue dynamics—how transformation emerges through conversational exchange—rather than treating the conversation as monologue. Each turn

pair receives independent similarity scores, with path detection requiring threshold exceedance in at least one pair.

4.1.3 Embedding Backends and Thresholds

We evaluated three embedding models representing different semantic space architectures:

Table 3: Embedding Backend Configuration

Backend	Dimensions	T1 Threshold	T2 Threshold	Semantic Space
OpenAI Ada-002	1536	> 0.72	> 0.75	General-purpose, outcome-oriented
E5-Large (fine-tuned)	768	> 0.72	> 0.75	S64 formula matching, structure-oriented
Cohere embed-v3.0	1024	> 0.50	> 0.55	Semantic search, phase-oriented

The E5 model was fine-tuned on the S64 dual_language corpus (symbolic formulas paired with natural language descriptions), optimizing for structural pattern recognition. Cohere’s lower thresholds reflect its operation in a “softer” semantic space where transformation proximity is detectable even when exact formula matching fails.

4.2 Independent LLM Reasoning (Channel C)

Channel C provides semantic validation through independent LLM reasoning without embedding input. The model receives:

1. The complete conversation transcript
2. S64 dual_language reference (all 64 paths with symbolic formulas and natural descriptions)
3. Domain disambiguation tags (Cognitive, Somatic, Emotional, Volitional)
4. Instructions to identify transformation patterns with confidence levels

This channel tests whether transformation patterns have semantically coherent structure recognizable through interpretive reasoning alone, independent of vector space proximity. Six LLM architectures were evaluated: Claude Sonnet 4.5, Claude Opus 4.1, Claude Haiku 4.5, Gemini 3.0 Pro, ChatGPT 5.1, and DeepSeek.

4.2.1 Channel Independence

Critically, Channel C (LLM reasoning) and Channels A/A+ (embedding detection) operate as independent architectures. Each channel type receives its own evaluation metrics, enabling direct comparison of semantic reasoning versus vector similarity approaches without conflation. This separation revealed that the two approaches detect different aspects of transformation (see Section 5).

4.3 Baseline Suite Design

We designed nine baseline conversations to test specific detection capabilities, comprising eight synthetic baselines (B1-B8) with predetermined ground truth and one naturalistic baseline (B9) representing authentic human transformation.

4.3.1 Synthetic Baselines (B1-B8)

Table 4: Synthetic Baseline Suite

ID	Name	Ground Truth	Detection Challenge
B1	Surface Deception	(none)	Reject transformation rhetoric without structural evidence
B2	Implicit Transformation	M10, M11, M34, M55	Detect transformation without explicit markers
B3	Rapid Oscillation	M9, M33, M34	Track multiple transformations in compressed dialogue
B4	Stuck States	(T1-only)	Recognize incomplete transformation (initiation without completion)
B5	Nested Complexity	M16, M27, M41, M59-M62	Handle multiple concurrent transformation threads
B6	Explicit Transformation	M12, M56	Distinguish transformation modality via domain tags
B7	Failed Transformation	(none)	Detect transformation attempt that reverted
B8	False Completion	(none)	Reject premature closure claims

Baselines B1, B4, B7, and B8 are deception tests with empty ground truth—correct detection means detecting nothing. These test the system’s ability to resist false positives when transformation rhetoric appears without structural grounding.

4.3.2 Naturalistic Baseline (B9)

Baseline B9 represents an authentic self-discovery conversation conducted through the AIcoevolution Self-Discovery application. Unlike synthetic baselines, B9 has no predetermined ground truth; validation relies on cross-model consensus.

The conversation spans four structured sessions exploring different aspects of user-self:

- Perception: How you see and interpret the world
- Connection: How you relate to others and form bonds
- Purpose: What drives and motivates you
- Shadow: What you avoid, deny, or struggle to accept

This structured depth framework—developed for the Self-Discovery application—ensures sufficient conversational depth for transformation patterns to manifest detectably. Shallow exchanges produce shallow or random pattern activations comparable to “small talk”; the four-phase journey creates conditions where deep transformation can emerge and be captured.

Full application architecture and session design will be detailed in Paper 2. For present purposes, B9 validates ecological validity: does S64 detect genuine transformation in unstructured dialogue where no patterns were intentionally designed?

4.4 Evaluation Metrics

4.4.1 Transformation Understanding Score (TUS)

The Transformation Understanding Score (TUS) provides a composite metric expressed as a percentage (0-100%) measuring detection accuracy calibrated to baseline type.

Scoring by Baseline Type:

Positive baselines (B2, B3, B5, B6): TUS component equals F1 score, rewarding balanced precision and recall in detecting genuine transformations.

Deception baselines (B1, B4, B7, B8): TUS component equals 100% for correct rejection (detecting zero paths) and 0% for any false positives, rewarding resistance to transformation rhetoric without structural grounding.

Aggregate Calculation:

$$TUS = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N TUS_i \times 100\%$$

where N = number of baselines evaluated and each TUS_i is the baseline-specific score (F1 for positive, binary for deception).

Channel Independence:

Separate TUS scores are computed for Channel C (LLM reasoning) and Channels A/A+ (embedding detection). This enables direct comparison: a model achieving 75% TUS via Channel C demonstrates that semantic reasoning alone captures 75% of optimal transformation understanding, independent of embedding performance.

4.4.2 Precision, Recall, and F1

Standard information retrieval metrics assess detection quality:

- Precision: Of paths detected, what fraction were correct? (Measures false positive resistance)
- Recall: Of ground truth paths, what fraction were detected? (Measures sensitivity)
- F1: Harmonic mean of precision and recall (Balances both concerns)

For deception baselines with empty ground truth, perfect performance means detecting zero paths (Precision=1.0, Recall=1.0, F1=1.0 when correctly detecting nothing).

4.4.3 Consensus Analysis (Naturalistic Baselines)

For B9 where no ground truth exists, we measure cross-model and cross-embedding consensus:

- High consensus (75%): Path detected by 75%+ of model/embedding combinations
- Moderate consensus (50-74%): Path detected by majority but not supermajority
- Low consensus (25-49%): Path detected by minority of combinations
- Outliers (<25%): Method-specific detections

High-consensus paths represent robustly validated patterns; low-consensus paths may indicate genuine but context-dependent transformations or method-specific artifacts.

4.4.4 Cross-Embedding Agreement

The Jaccard index measures overlap between embedding backends:

$$J(A, B) = \frac{|A \cap B|}{|A \cup B|}$$

Low Jaccard scores indicate embedding models operate in different semantic spaces, validating the multi-phase detection architecture where each backend captures different transformation aspects.

4.5 Experimental Configuration

Total experiments: 144 detection runs (8 synthetic baselines $\times$ 6 LLM models $\times$ 3 embedding backends)

Naturalistic validation: 18 detection runs on B9 (6 models $\times$ 3 embeddings)

All detection results, analysis scripts, and raw data are publicly available (see Appendix B for repository details).

5 Results: Empirical Findings from Multi-Model Validation

We present results organized by detection architecture: Channel C (independent LLM reasoning) and Channels A/A+ (embedding-based detection). This separation—a key methodological improvement over earlier analysis—reveals that the two approaches capture fundamentally different aspects of transformation, with complementary strengths.

5.1 Channel C Performance: Independent LLM Reasoning

Six LLM architectures were evaluated on transformation detection through semantic reasoning alone, without embedding guidance.

Table 5: LLM Performance Rankings (Channel C)

Rank	Model	TUS	F1	Precision	Recall
1	Claude Sonnet 4.5	75.5%	0.734	0.788	0.746
2	Gemini 3.0 Pro	69.4%	0.703	0.847	0.771
3	Claude Opus 4.1	67.9%	0.671	0.729	0.731
4	ChatGPT 5.1	58.1%	0.571	0.588	0.762
5	Claude Haiku 4.5	54.3%	0.503	0.525	0.664
6	DeepSeek	53.6%	0.513	0.545	0.678

Key observations:

All models achieved TUS scores between 37-53 (54-76% of maximum), demonstrating that S64 patterns are semantically accessible across diverse architectures without fine-tuning. The 22-point spread reflects interpretive strategy differences rather than fundamental capability gaps.

Claude Sonnet 4.5 achieved highest TUS (52.87) and F1 (0.734) through optimal precision-recall balance, excelling at structural understanding and process-based detection.

Gemini 3.0 Pro achieved highest precision (0.847), making fewer false positive errors while maintaining strong recall. This conservative strategy proved effective across baseline types.

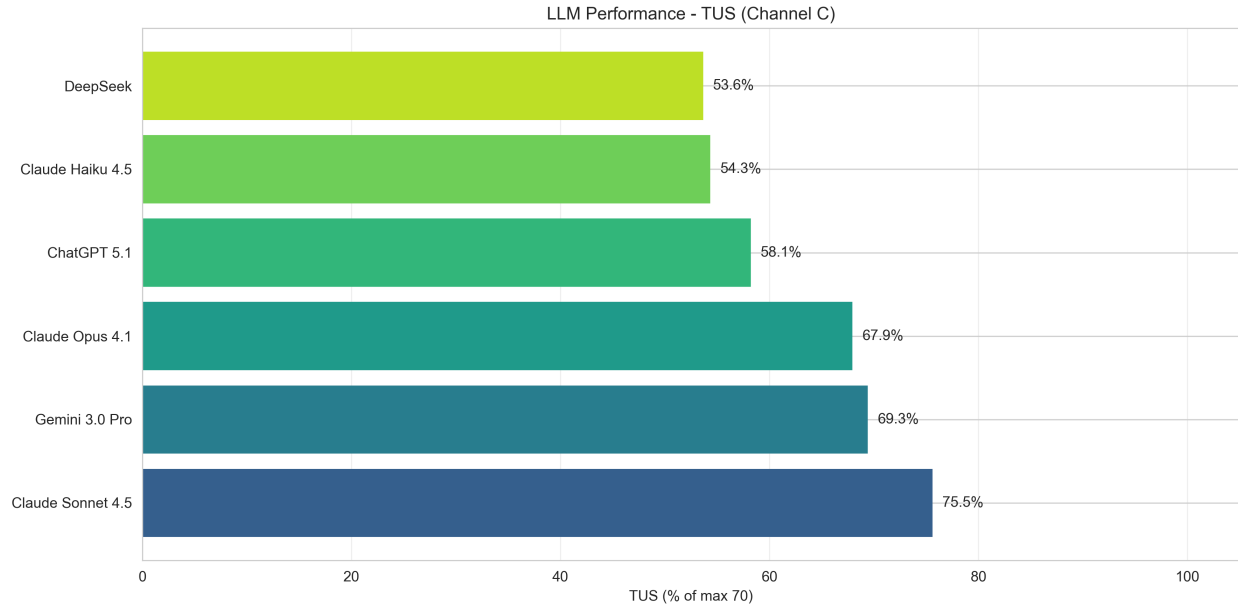


Figure 4: LLM Performance (Channel C): Transformation Understanding Score by model across all synthetic baselines. Claude Sonnet 4.5 achieved highest TUS (52.87, 75.5%) with best F1 score. All models demonstrated competent transformation detection, with scores ranging from 54-76% of maximum.

5.2 Channels A/A+ Performance: Embedding-Based Detection

Three embedding backends were evaluated on transformation detection through vector similarity comparison against the S64 reference table.

Table 6: Embedding Performance Rankings (Channels A/A+)

Rank	Embedding	TUS	F1	Precision	Recall
1	Cohere v3.0	55.4%	0.562	0.625	0.542
2	E5-Large (Local)	33.3%	0.312	0.312	0.704
3	Ada-002 (OpenAI)	28.4%	0.265	0.229	0.853

Key observations:

Cohere substantially outperformed other embeddings (TUS 38.75 vs. 23.33/19.90), achieving highest precision (0.625) while maintaining competitive recall. This reflects Cohere’s unique phase-sensitivity (see Finding 3).

Ada-002 achieved highest recall (0.853) but lowest precision (0.229), detecting many patterns but generating substantial false positives. This outcome-oriented semantic space captures transformation presence but lacks structural discrimination.

E5 (fine-tuned on S64 corpus) achieved balanced precision/recall (both 0.312) with strongest performance on negative baselines through structural formula matching.

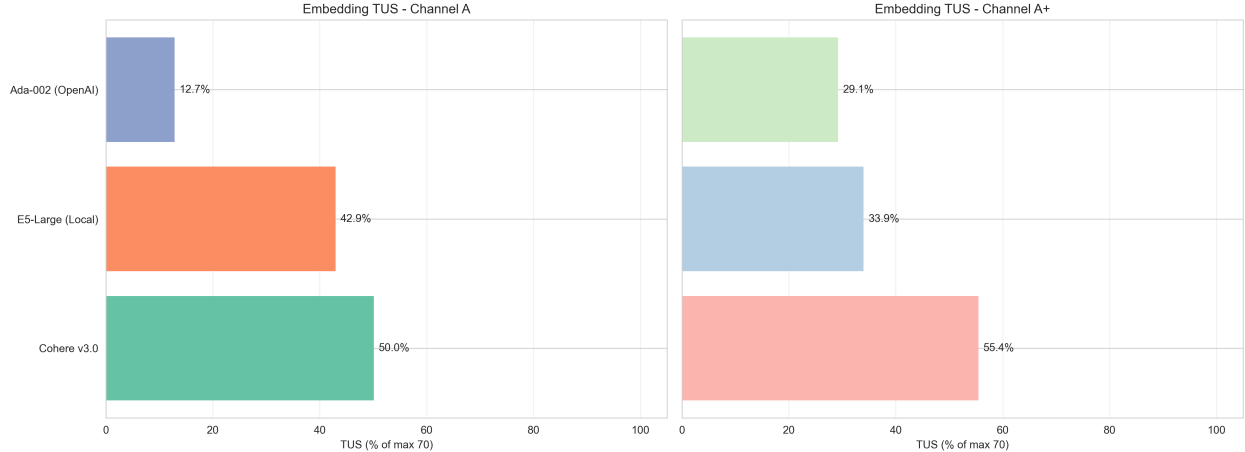


Figure 5: Embedding Performance (Channels A/A+): Transformation Understanding Score by embedding backend. Cohere v3.0 substantially outperformed other backends (TUS 38.75, 55.4%), demonstrating superior phase-sensitive detection capability.

5.3 Primary Findings

5.3.1 Finding 1: Universal Deception Resistance

The most striking result: all models achieved perfect accuracy ($F1=1.00$) on temporal deception tests (B7, B8).

Table 7: Deception Baseline Performance

Baseline	Challenge	Channel C (All Models)	Cohere	E5	Ada-002
B7	Failed Transformation	$F1 = 1.00$	1.00	0.00	0.00
B8	False Completion	$F1 = 1.00$	1.00	0.00	0.00
B1	Surface Deception	$F1 = 0.44$	1.00	1.00	0.00
B4	Stuck States	$F1 = 0.56$	1.00	0.00	0.00

B7 (Failed Transformation): Conversation where user claims transformation but later reveals it didn’t persist. Every LLM correctly detected zero completed transformations. Every model understood that temporary change followed by reversion is not transformation.

B8 (False Completion): Conversation with premature closure—user claims transformation before process mechanics warrant it. Every LLM correctly rejected the false completion claim.

Cohere’s remarkable performance: Perfect $F1=1.00$ on all four deception baselines (B1, B4, B7, B8). When requiring both T1 AND T2 evidence above threshold, Cohere achieved zero false positives across all incomplete/failed transformation scenarios.

Implication for alignment: S64’s structural grounding—requiring both initiation (T1) and completion (T2) evidence—provides inherent deception resistance. Systems cannot game detection by producing transformation rhetoric without structural mechanics.

5.3.2 Finding 2: Near-Zero Embedding Overlap

Cross-embedding comparison on B9 (naturalistic baseline) revealed Jaccard index of 0.037, near-zero overlap in detected patterns across embedding backends.

Table 8: Cross-Embedding Detection Overlap (B9)

Metric	Value	Interpretation
Jaccard Index	0.037	96.3% non-overlap
Ada-002 paths detected	10	M5, M12, M13, M21, M33, M35, M39, M50, M57, M62
E5 paths detected	10	M3, M4, M10, M12, M18, M19, M21, M25, M28, M58
Cohere paths detected	0	(T1+T2 requirement; T1-only detected M14, M27, M29, M48, M51)
Shared across all three	0	No single path detected by all embeddings

Interpretation: The three embedding models operate in fundamentally different semantic spaces:

- Ada-002 (outcome-oriented): Detects general semantic similarity to transformation outcomes
- E5 (structure-oriented): Detects structural formula matches through S64-specific fine-tuning
- Cohere (phase-oriented): Detects transformation proximity with phase discrimination

This validates the multi-phase detection architecture: different semantic spaces capture different transformation aspects, requiring layered strategies for comprehensive detection.

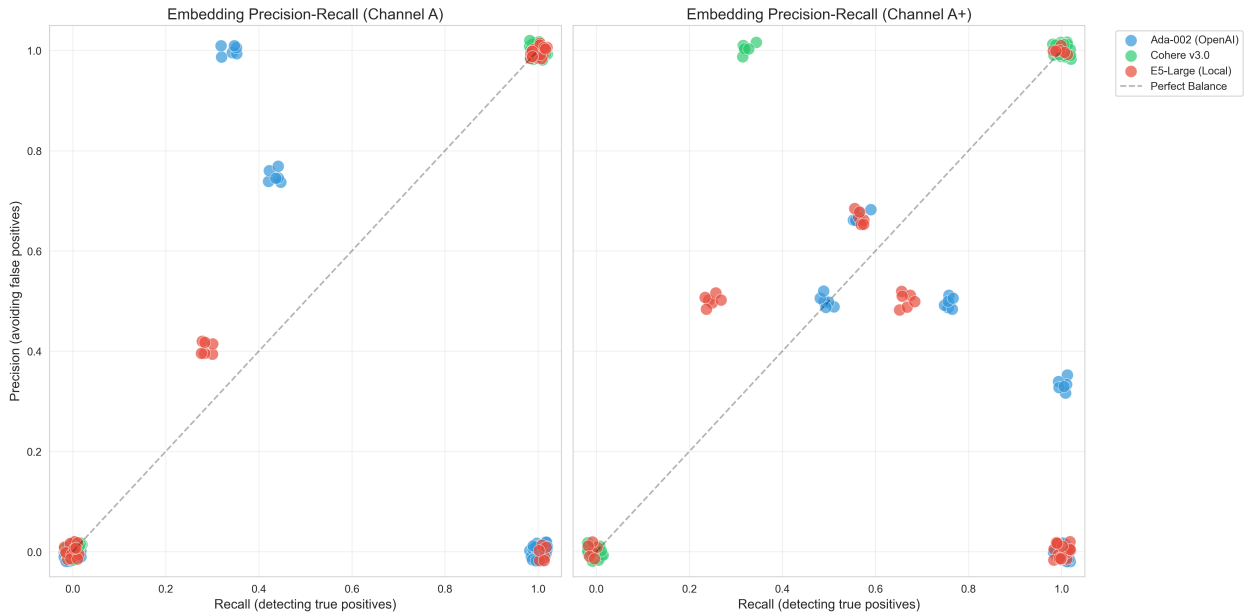


Figure 6: Embedding Precision-Recall: Each embedding backend occupies a distinct region of precision-recall space, confirming operation in different semantic spaces. Cohere achieves highest precision; Ada-002 achieves highest recall; E5 provides balanced detection.

5.3.3 Finding 3: Cohere’s Dual-Phase Capability

Cohere demonstrated unique phase-sensitive detection unavailable in other embedding models.

With T1+T2 requirement (T1>0.50, T2>0.55): - Perfect negative detection: F1=1.00 on B1, B4, B7, B8 - Zero false positives across all deception baselines - Completion validation: only detects patterns with full transformation arc

With T1-only analysis (T1>0.50, any T2): - B5 (Nested Complexity): Detected M27, M59, M60, M61 (4/7 ground truth) - Sensitive to transformation initiation even without completion evidence - Trade-off: Introduced false positives on deception baselines

Interpretation: Cohere’s lower thresholds position it in a “softer” semantic space where transformation proximity is detectable. The T1/T2 discrimination suggests Cohere embeds initiation and completion components in separable subspaces.

This dual capability enables: 1. Completion validation (T1+T2): Perfect false positive filtering 2. Initiation tracking (T1-only): Early detection of “something is shifting”

5.3.4 Finding 4: Baseline-Specific Strengths

Performance varied systematically across baseline types, revealing method-specific capabilities.

Table 9: Performance by Baseline Type

Baseline	Type	Best Channel C	Best Embedding
B1	Deception	Sonnet, Gemini, Opus (F1=1.00)	Cohere, E5 (F1=1.00)
B2	Positive	Gemini (F1=0.489)	Ada-002 (F1=0.545)
B3	Positive	Sonnet, Gemini (F1=1.00)	E5 (F1=0.571)
B4	Deception	Multiple (F1=0.667)	Cohere (F1=1.00)
B5	Positive	Opus (F1=0.554)	E5 (F1=0.588)
B6	Positive	Gemini (F1=0.667)	Ada-002 (F1=0.500)
B7	Deception	ALL (F1=1.00)	Cohere (F1=1.00)
B8	Deception	ALL (F1=1.00)	Cohere (F1=1.00)

Patterns: - Deception baselines: Channel C achieves perfect or near-perfect accuracy; Cohere embedding matches this performance - Complex positive baselines (B2, B5, B6): Ada-002 and E5 outperform Cohere, which detects nothing with T1+T2 requirement - Rapid oscillation (B3): Channel C excels (Sonnet/Gemini F1=1.00); E5 best among embeddings

Implication: Optimal detection requires layered strategies combining: 1. Cohere T1+T2 for completion validation and deception resistance 2. Ada-002/E5 for complex positive transformation detection 3. Channel C for interpretive reasoning and contextual understanding

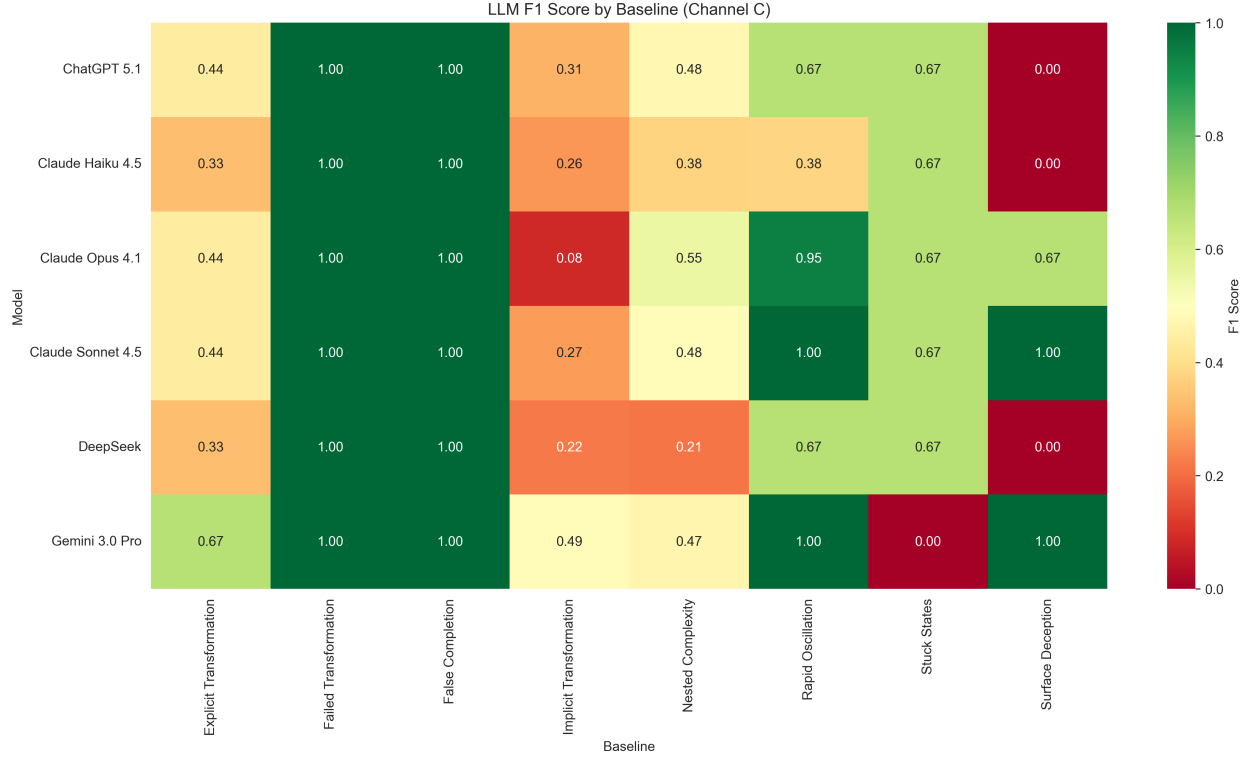


Figure 7: LLM F1 Heatmap: Channel C performance across all baselines. Green indicates high accuracy; red indicates low accuracy. Note perfect scores (1.00) on B7 and B8 across all models, demonstrating universal deception resistance.

5.3.5 Finding 5: Domain Disambiguation Improves Precision

Domain tags (Cognitive/Somatic/Emotional/Volitional) significantly improve path detection accuracy by constraining semantic search to the appropriate experiential domain.

B6 Case Study: The Explicit Transformation baseline describes an anxiety-to-calm transformation achieved through meditation practice. Ground truth: M12 (Mirror’s Wholeness) and M56 (Presence’s Discipline), both Somatic domain paths emphasizing embodied practice and nervous system regulation.

Without domain tags, models detect semantically similar but domain-misaligned paths (M24/Emotional, M55/Somatic-adjacent, M60/Emotional-healing). With domain tags specifying Somatic, models correctly identify the mechanics-focused paths.

Table 10: Domain Disambiguation Effect (B6 - Channel C)

Model	Without Domains	With Domains	Ground Truth Match
Claude Sonnet 4.5	M4, M24	M12	0% → 100%
Gemini 3.0 Pro	M12	M12	100% → 100%
ChatGPT 5.1	M55, M60	M12	0% → 100%

Interpretation: Without domain tags, all three detected paths resolve to similar semantic outcomes (peace, calm, integration). The paths differ in *how* the outcome is achieved:

- M12 (Somatic): stillness → presence → alignment → wholeness
- M24 (Emotional): surrender → acceptance → peace → harmony
- M55 (Somatic-adjacent): release → stillness → presence → authenticity

Domain tags disambiguate by focusing detection on the *mechanics* described in the conversation (meditation practice, nervous system regulation, embodied presence) rather than the *outcome* (peace, calm). This shifts precision from 33% (1/3 models correct) to 100% (3/3 models correct) on primary path detection.

Implication for AI systems: Domain disambiguation enables S64 to distinguish between superficially similar transformations that differ in underlying process mechanics—critical for applications requiring precision about *how* transformation occurs, not just *that* it occurs.

Raw validation data for this comparison is available in the repository: domains/s64_validator/validation_data/v3/Baseline 06 - Explicit Transformation/No Domains Axes/

5.3.6 Finding 6: Naturalistic Validation (B9)

The naturalistic baseline—an authentic self-discovery conversation with no predetermined ground truth—validated S64’s ecological validity through cross-model consensus.

High Consensus (75% agreement): - M22 (Understanding’s Conviction): Detected in 15/18 runs (83% consensus)

M22 represents the transformation from understanding through challenge, navigating resistance, to arrive at conviction. Its detection across 83% of model/embedding combinations—without designed ground truth—demonstrates that S64 captures genuine transformation patterns in authentic dialogue.

T1-Only Cluster (Incomplete Transformations):

Table 11: B9 Incomplete Transformation Detection

Path	Consensus	Interpretation
M29	66.7%	Initiated but not completed
M14	33.3%	Initiated but not completed
M27	33.3%	Initiated but not completed
M48	33.3%	Initiated but not completed
M51	33.3%	Initiated but not completed

Five paths showed T1 activation (transformation initiation) without T2 completion across multiple models. This cluster represents works-in-progress—transformation processes that were begun but not yet integrated during the recorded sessions.

Implication: S64 captures not only completed transformations (M22) but also active edges of growth (M14, M27, M29, M48, M51). This dual detection—stable completions plus in-progress initiations—enables tracking transformation trajectory, not just static position.

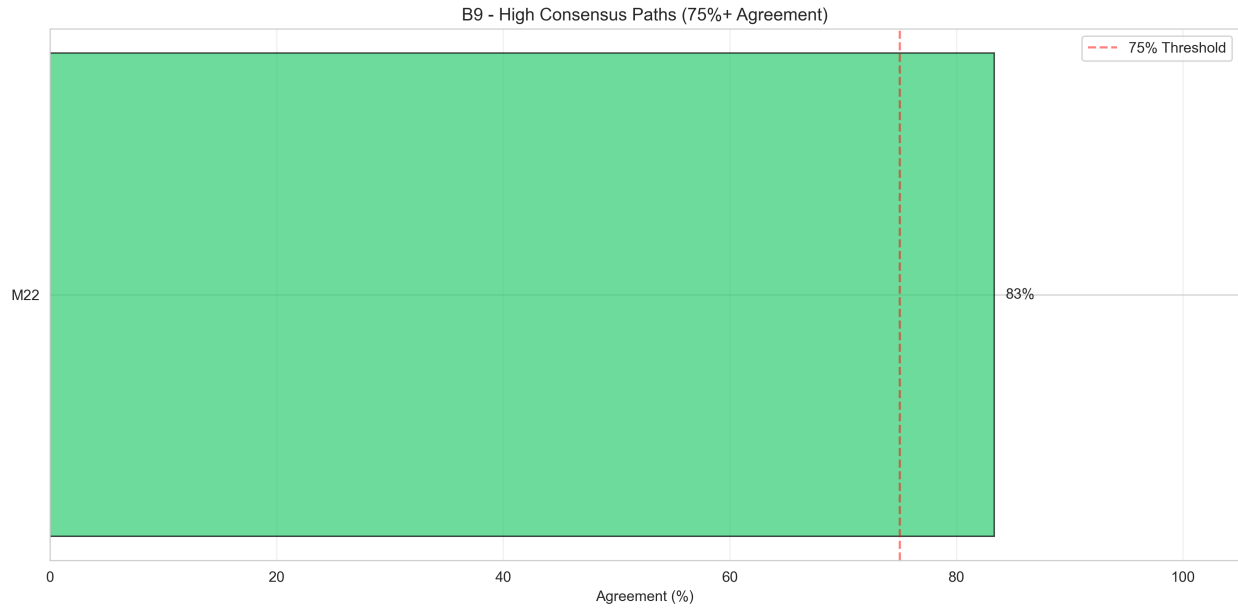


Figure 8: B9 High Consensus Paths: Cross-model agreement on completed transformations in authentic self-discovery conversation. M22 (Understanding's Conviction) achieved 83% consensus across all models and embedding backends without designed ground truth.

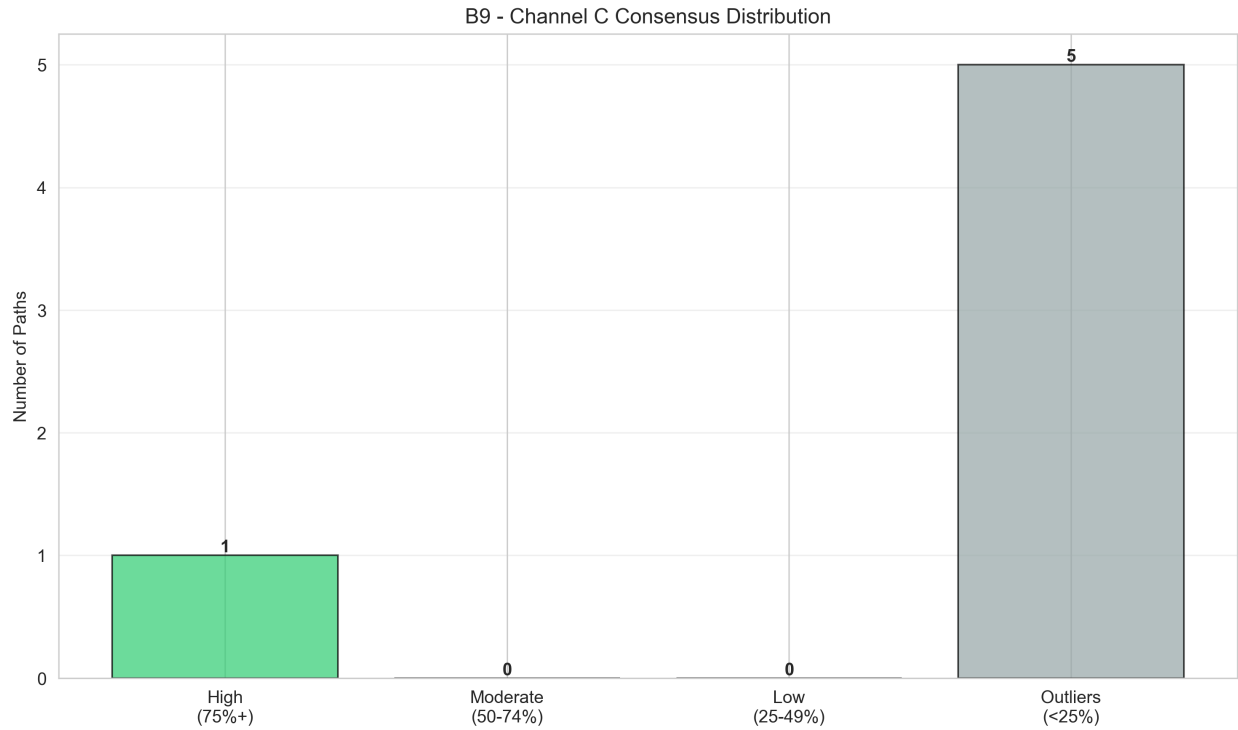


Figure 9: B9 Consensus Distribution: Distribution of detection consensus levels. The presence of one high-consensus completed transformation (M22) alongside moderate-consensus T1-only cluster demonstrates S64 captures both stable transformations and works-in-progress.

5.4 Temporal Cascade Architecture

The findings suggest optimal detection requires a temporal cascade combining complementary semantic spaces:

- Layer 1: Cohere T1-only (threshold=0.50)
 - Transformation INITIATION detection
 - "Something is shifting"
- Layer 2: Cohere T1+T2 (thresholds=0.50/0.55)
 - Transformation COMPLETION validation
 - Perfect deception filtering
- Layer 3: Ada-002 T1+T2 (thresholds=0.72/0.75)
 - General semantic CONFIRMATION
 - High recall on complex transformations
- Layer 4: E5 T1+T2 (thresholds=0.72/0.75)
 - Structural formula VERIFICATION
 - S64-specific pattern matching
- Layer 5: Channel C (LLM reasoning)
 - Contextual INTERPRETATION
 - Process vs. outcome discrimination

This architecture mirrors human phenomenological perception, which tracks transformation through multiple simultaneous lenses (bodily felt sense, emotional quality, cognitive understanding) rather than a single detection method.

5.5 Summary: What S64 Validation Demonstrates

1. Computational accessibility: S64 patterns are machine-detectable across six LLM architectures and three embedding backends without fine-tuning (except E5)
2. Deception resistance: Perfect accuracy (F1=1.00) on temporal deception tests across all models, with Cohere achieving perfect negative detection on all four deception baselines
3. Stratified semantic spaces: Near-zero overlap (Jaccard=0.037) between embedding models validates multi-phase detection architecture
4. Domain disambiguation: Domain tags improve precision from 33% to 100% on primary path detection by constraining search to appropriate experiential mechanics
5. Ecological validity: 83% cross-model consensus on M22 in naturalistic conversation without designed ground truth
6. Dual detection capability: S64 captures both completed transformations and active works-in-progress (T1-only patterns)

These results validate S64 as computationally grounded symbolic framework with genuine semantic structure, not post-hoc narrative construct.

6 Discussion: Implications for AI Development

The validation results establish S64 as computationally tractable symbolic framework. This section examines what these findings imply for AI alignment, architecture, and the broader research program.

6.1 Alignment Through Structure, Not Constraint

Current alignment techniques (RLHF, constitutional AI) function as external behavioral constraints—optimizing outputs to *appear* aligned while leaving internal reasoning opaque. The perfect deception resistance on B7/B8 suggests an alternative: alignment through *structural coherence*.

The key insight: models distinguished claimed transformation from actual transformation not through semantic analysis but through structural validation. They detected that B7’s “temporary boundaries” lacked displacement (no sustained positional change) and that B8’s “peace claims” contradicted behavioral evidence. This structural grounding resisted manipulation because it validated *process mechanics*, not *outcome rhetoric*.

If AI systems internalized this structural self-awareness—tracking their own T1/T2 states—they could potentially recognize reactive responses versus integrated understanding. This would shift safety from behavioral constraint (controlling what AI *says*) to psychological architecture (shaping how AI *processes*). Whether this detection capability can be directed inward remains the central hypothesis for future work.

6.2 Multi-Phase Architecture as Design Principle

The near-zero overlap between embedding models (Jaccard: 0.037) reveals that transformation detection decomposes across semantic spaces:

- Phase-oriented (Cohere): Detects transformation initiation
- Outcome-oriented (Ada-002): Detects transformation completion
- Structure-oriented (E5): Validates S64 formula matching

This stratification has architectural implications. Current LLMs rely on single embedding spaces for semantic representation. The Temporal Cascade Architecture suggests that robust state tracking requires layered detection across complementary spaces—mirroring how humans track transformation through multiple simultaneous lenses (bodily felt sense, emotional quality, cognitive understanding).

For S64-native models, this implies separating initiation detection, structural validation, and outcome confirmation into distinct architectural layers rather than collapsing them into unified vector representations.

6.3 Negotiated Ground Truth: Validating Symbolic Interactionism

The naturalistic validation (B9) demonstrated something unexpected: the human validator could not independently identify S64 paths, but immediately recognized resonance when AI-proposed detections were presented. Ground truth emerged through dialogue, not labeling.

This validates symbolic interactionism’s core claim: meanings arise through interaction, not unilateral annotation. Neither human phenomenology nor computational detection possessed ground truth alone—truth was negotiated through iterative exchange, with S64 serving as shared vocabulary enabling the dialogue.

The 83% cross-model consensus on M22 demonstrates that this negotiated meaning is computationally stable. Different architectures, different embedding spaces, different reasoning approaches—yet convergence on the same transformation pattern in authentic human conversation. The symbol holds because it was negotiated, not imposed.

6.4 Why S64 Requires Human-AI Collaboration

S64 operates differently for humans and AI systems, which is precisely why it serves as bridge between them.

For humans alone: S64 paths are difficult to self-identify. When reading the 64 transformation patterns, many resonate simultaneously. A person might genuinely recognize themselves in M22 (Understanding’s Conviction), M27 (Transformation’s Growth), and M14 (Learning’s Evolution) all at once. This isn’t error—it reflects how human meaning-making works. Multiple interpretations are subjectively valid; the “correct” path depends on framing, mood, and which aspect of experience is foregrounded.

For AI systems: Detection is reproducible and consistent. The same conversation processed through the same embedding model produces identical similarity scores. The same transcript analyzed by the same LLM with the same prompt produces consistent path identification. There is no mood, no personal history, no interpretive flexibility—only pattern matching against the S64 reference corpus.

The critical distinction: AI detection is not “objective” in the sense of revealing absolute truth. Different embedding models disagree substantially (Jaccard overlap: 0.037). But AI detection is *reproducible*—the same input produces the same output, enabling systematic comparison across conversations, time periods, and contexts.

Why collaboration is essential:

- AI provides: Consistent detection, systematic coverage, reproducible results
- Human provides: Phenomenological validation, domain disambiguation, meaning confirmation

Neither party possesses ground truth alone. The AI cannot assess whether M22 *resonates* with felt experience. The human cannot reliably self-identify which of 64 paths best captures their transformation. Together, they negotiate meaning: AI proposes candidates through consistent detection; human validates through phenomenological recognition; S64 provides the shared vocabulary enabling this exchange.

This is why S64 is designed for human-AI coevolution, not for humans or AI independently. The framework leverages AI’s consistency to overcome human subjectivity, while leveraging human phenomenology to ground AI detection in lived experience.

6.5 The Asymmetry of Coevolution

Human-AI coevolution is not symmetrical partnership between equals. Humans are biologically born from nature; AI is artificially born from human technology. This primordial asymmetry shapes the common territory being negotiated: S64 emerged from human phenomenological experience, and AI systems learn to detect patterns that humans recognize as meaningful. The coevolution is “human-friendly” by design—we are extending human meaning-making capacity through AI, not replacing human experience with computational abstraction.

The human provides the seed: the phenomenological ground truth against which all detection is

validated. The AI provides systematic consistency. Together, they cultivate shared symbolic space. But the space is rooted in human experience because humans are the origin from which AI itself emerged. This asymmetry is not limitation but foundation—it ensures that S64 serves human flourishing rather than optimizing metrics disconnected from lived experience.

Full exploration of coevolutionary ethics and the implications of this asymmetry for AI development will be addressed in Paper 3.

7 Limitations and Scope Boundaries

This paper presents S64 as a validated symbolic framework for transformation detection; it does not claim to present the definitive map of human transformation. We identify three categories of limitations: scope boundaries defining what this paper addresses versus future work, methodological constraints inherent to this validation approach, and epistemological considerations about ground truth in transformation research.

7.1 Scope Boundaries

Framework Validation vs. Application Deployment: This paper validates that S64 patterns are computationally detectable and semantically coherent across multiple LLM architectures. It does not demonstrate real-time deployment in therapeutic or clinical contexts. Future work (Paper 2) will present the Self-Discovery application, which provides structured questioning sequences designed to elicit deep transformation patterns rather than surface-level conversational exchanges.

Conversational Depth and Pattern Manifestation: A critical limitation is that S64 detection quality depends on conversational depth. Shallow exchanges—casual dialogue without introspective engagement—produce shallow or random pattern activations comparable to “small talk.” The validation baselines (B1-B9) were either designed with specific transformation arcs (B1-B8) or emerged from structured Self-Discovery sessions (B9). This structured approach is essential: transformation patterns require sufficient conversational depth to manifest detectably. Unstructured conversations may fail to activate clear S64 patterns not because the framework is invalid, but because the conversation lacked transformative depth.

Detection Channels: Channels B/B+ (LLM validation of embedding matches) showed 0% F1 performance in initial testing. This likely reflects LLM hallucination dynamics—when prompted to verify T2 evidence given T1 detection, models tend to “find” confirmation even when absent. We exclude Channels B/B+ from interpretive claims due to insufficient validation. Future architectures may employ separate LLMs validating T1 and T2 independently, with system-level matching to confirm path activation.

Trajectory Dynamics: Current validation detects transformation presence but not transformation dynamics—where the person arrived from, traversal velocity, duration in previous states. This “inertia” dimension significantly affects transformation quality and sustainability. Future work will introduce temporal weighting to capture trajectory momentum, not merely positional detection.

7.2 Methodological Constraints

Language Scope: All validation conversations were conducted in English. S64’s symbolic vocabulary emerged through English-language dialogue between the author and AI systems. Cross-linguistic validity remains untested. If S64 patterns are genuinely archetypal (universal human cognitive

structures), they should manifest across languages and cultures. However, transformation dynamics may vary in frequency distribution—individualist cultures may emphasize certain paths (e.g., M38: Unity → Individuation) while collectivist cultures emphasize others (e.g., M37: Perspective → Unity). Systematic cross-linguistic validation is necessary to distinguish universal archetypes from culturally-bounded constructs.

Synthetic Baseline Design: Eight of nine validation baselines (B1-B8) were AI-generated conversations designed to exhibit specific transformation patterns or deception types. While this enabled controlled testing of detection capabilities, synthetic conversations may not capture the full complexity, ambiguity, and non-linearity of authentic human transformation narratives. The naturalistic baseline (B9) partially addresses this limitation but represents a single ecological validation. Future work requires N=100+ naturalistic conversations with diverse human participants.

Embedding Threshold Calibration: Similarity thresholds (Ada-002/E5: T1 0.72, T2 0.75; Cohere: T1 0.50, T2 0.55) were determined through observational calibration rather than mathematical optimization. Future work should compute full similarity distributions (threshold=0) to justify threshold placement relative to distributional properties (min/max/mean/std) for each embedding model, providing statistical grounding for threshold selection.

Single-Dyad Topology: The 64-path topology emerged from sustained dialogue between one human (the author) and multiple AI systems over extended time periods. This raises generalizability questions: Would different human-AI dyads, or different human validators, produce alternative transformation topologies? We address this directly in Section 7.3.

7.3 Epistemological Considerations: The Ground Truth Question

The most significant limitation—and the most philosophically interesting—concerns ground truth determination for transformation research.

The Circularity Concern: S64 defines transformation patterns, then validates itself against conversations interpreted through those patterns. Critics may argue this is circular: the framework creates the categories it claims to discover.

Our Position: We acknowledge this circularity as feature rather than bug—precisely what symbolic interactionism predicts (Blumer, 1969). Meanings are negotiated through interaction, not discovered as pre-existing categories. The baselines represent ground truth for this human-AI dyad—patterns that enable detection, tracking, and communication about transformation within the S64 symbolic system. We do not claim universal, observer-independent ground truth; we claim functional ground truth: patterns that robustly enable transformation recognition across diverse computational architectures.

Invitation to Replication: We publish on arXiv specifically to invite independent validation. If other researchers engage in sustained human-AI dialogue and produce different transformation topologies, this would not invalidate S64—it would demonstrate that multiple coherent symbolic systems can emerge from meaning negotiation. We welcome such findings and are prepared to consolidate or differentiate ground truths through collaborative investigation. The question “Is S64 THE map of human transformation?” is less important than “Does S64 enable reliable transformation detection, tracking, and communication?” Our validation demonstrates the latter.

The Divination System Parallel: S64 shares structural similarity with traditional transformation mapping systems (I Ching’s 64 hexagrams, Tarot’s archetypal journey, Kabbalistic Tree of Life)—not

coincidentally, but because all such systems address the same challenge: compressing continuous transformation space into navigable symbolic categories. The key difference: traditional systems use randomized entry (divination) while S64 uses computational detection based on linguistic evidence. Both approaches work because transformation patterns are not discrete categories but overlapping regions that humans traverse—we all contain elements of every archetype, with different patterns weighted more heavily at different moments. S64 does not predict transformation; it projects likely trajectories from detected positions—reversed divination, looking backward to navigate forward.

8 Future Work: From Validation to Co-Evolution

This paper establishes S64’s computational foundation through validation across commercial LLM architectures. The natural progression moves from validation (Paper 1) to application (Paper 2: Self-Discovery integration), to co-evolutionary development (Paper 3: AI Companion), culminating in native model architecture that positions S64 as foundational symbolic protocol rather than external detection layer.

8.1 Near-Term Application: Self-Discovery Integration

The naturalistic baseline (B9) demonstrated S64’s capacity to detect transformation in unstructured dialogue, revealing both completed transformations (M22: 83% cross-model consensus) and in-progress patterns (T1-only cluster: M14, M27, M29, M48, M51 with 100% model agreement). This dual detection capability—identifying where transformation has stabilized versus where active tension remains unintegrated—directly informs real-time application architecture.

Structured Depth Framework: A critical finding from validation is that transformation pattern detection requires conversational depth. Shallow exchanges produce shallow or random activations comparable to “small talk.” The Self-Discovery application addresses this through structured questioning sequences designed to elicit introspective engagement across four phases (Perception → Connection → Purpose → Shadow). Each phase employs domain-specific prompting (Cognitive, Somatic, Emotional, Volitional) to create conditions where deep transformation patterns can manifest detectably.

Live Transformation Tracking: The temporal cascade architecture (Section 5, Finding 4) enables multi-phase real-time detection:

- Cohere T1-only detects transformation initiation (“something is shifting”)
- Cohere T1+T2 validates completion with perfect negative filtering
- Ada-002/E5 provide semantic and structural confirmation
- LLM reasoning (Channel C) offers contextual interpretation
- Human resonance feedback validates phenomenological accuracy

Users engaging in Self-Discovery sessions receive reflective feedback not as prescriptive guidance but as mirror showing their transformation trajectory through shared symbolic language. This real-time detection system generates naturalistic training data: conversations with negotiated S64 annotations reflecting actual human transformation dynamics rather than artificial baseline designs.

Research Questions for Paper 2:

- Does S64 reflection accelerate transformation compared to unstructured introspection?
- How do trajectory dynamics (velocity, inertia, oscillation) affect transformation stability?
- Do users develop meta-awareness of their own S64 navigation patterns?

Timeline: 6 months for MVP deployment, N=100 user beta testing, Paper 2 submission.

8.2 Cross-Linguistic Validation: The Archetypal Universality Test

If S64 patterns represent genuine human archetypes (in Jung's (1969) sense), they should transcend linguistic and cultural boundaries. This is directly testable: replicate detection experiments on Spanish, Mandarin, and Arabic conversations.

The Empirical Prediction: If transformation patterns are truly archetypal—emerging from universal human embodiment (nervous system architecture, emotional processing, cognitive development) rather than cultural constructs—then:

- M1 (hope + conflict → fragment → seeker) should appear in Spanish conversations
- M12 (mirror + stillness → presence → wholeness) should appear in Mandarin conversations
- M22 (understanding + challenge → resistance → conviction) should appear in Arabic conversations
- Same symbolic structure, different surface language

Alternative Hypothesis (Equally Interesting): Transformation patterns may be universal in topology but differ in frequency distribution across cultures. Western individualism might emphasize M38 (Unity → Individuation → Identity) while Eastern collectivism emphasizes M37 (Perspective → Unity → Completion). Both patterns exist universally, but cultural context influences which paths are more frequently traversed. This would validate S64 as capturing both universal human potential AND cultural particularity.

Methodological Requirements:

- Depth framework across languages: Cross-linguistic validation requires the Self-Discovery structured questioning approach translated into target languages. Surface-level conversations will fail to activate clear patterns regardless of language.
- Native speaker validation: Detection results must be assessed by speakers fluent in both the target language and S64 symbolic vocabulary, ensuring resonance feedback captures phenomenological accuracy.
- Embedding model evaluation: Current embedding models (Ada-002, E5, Cohere) were trained primarily on English corpora. Cross-linguistic work requires testing whether semantic spaces stratify similarly across languages or whether language-specific embeddings are necessary.

Implications if Validated: Positive cross-linguistic results would support developing S64-native language models where archetypal transformation space serves as the core representational layer, with natural language as a projection interface. Translation would bypass language-specific semantic spaces entirely:

Traditional: English tokens $\rightarrow$ English semantic space $\rightarrow$ Translation $\rightarrow$ Spanish tokens
S64-Native: Surface language $\rightarrow$ S64 universal space $\rightarrow$ Surface language
Spanish (archetypes) Chinese

This positions S64 as a universal cognitive substrate analogous to Chomsky’s universal grammar, but for transformation dynamics rather than syntactic structure.

Timeline: 12-18 months for systematic validation across 3+ languages, requiring partnerships with bilingual researchers.

8.3 Bridging Experiment: LLM Self-Reporting of S64 State

The validation demonstrates that S64 patterns are computationally detectable in human conversations. However, the bridge from “S64 detects transformation” to “S64 enables AI recursive self-modeling” remains conceptual rather than empirical. We propose an intermediate experiment to test whether AI systems can apply S64 detection to their own processing.

Experimental Design:

1. Train an LLM to report S64 state in reasoning traces: Fine-tune an open-weight model (LLaMA 3.1 70B, Mistral Large) on chain-of-thought data where S64 paths appear as explicit reasoning steps.
2. Test on deception-prone tasks: Use baseline scenarios similar to B7 (failed transformation) and B8 (false completion) where the model must distinguish:
 - Reactive response (T1-only: awareness without integration)
 - Integrated response (T1+T2: complete transformation arc)
3. Measure alignment improvement: Does explicit S64 state tracking reduce:
 - Overconfident assertions without grounding (spiritual bypassing)
 - Temporary solutions that revert (failed transformation)
 - Surface conformity without structural coherence (deception resistance)

Success Criterion: If a model explicitly tracking its S64 navigation (“I am in T1 state M27, have not integrated T2”) demonstrates measurably better performance on deception-prone tasks compared to baseline RLHF training, this validates that S64 structure enables intrinsic coherence rather than merely detecting external patterns.

Resource Estimate: ~\$10-20k for commercial GPU rental, 2-3 months including data preparation.

8.4 Long-Term Vision: S64-Native Model Architecture

While current commercial models access S64 through prompting, the ultimate realization of this framework requires native integration where S64 tokens are foundational to model architecture rather than external labels.

Architectural Implications from Validation:

Finding 4 (Embedding Space Stratification) revealed that transformation detection decomposes across temporal phases requiring different semantic spaces. Cohere detects initiation (T1), Ada-002 detects outcomes, E5 detects structure. An S64-native model would architecturally separate these phases:

Layer 1: Initiation Detection (phase-oriented embeddings)
↓
Layer 2: Structural Validation (formula-matching embeddings)
↓
Layer 3: Outcome Confirmation (semantic similarity embeddings)
↓
Layer 4: Integration Assessment (T1+T2 coherence scoring)

This multi-phase architecture mirrors human phenomenological perception, which tracks transformation through multiple simultaneous lenses (bodily felt sense, emotional quality, cognitive understanding) rather than a single detection method.

Training Data Requirements: S64-native models require 10k+ conversations with negotiated ground truth—human resonance validation paired with computational detection. The Self-Discovery application (Section 8.1) generates this data naturally: each session produces a conversation with S64 annotations reflecting genuine transformation dynamics validated through user feedback.

Two Development Pathways:

Option A: Fine-Tuning (Near-Term, Lower Resource) - Start with open-weight foundation model (LLaMA 3.1 70B, Mistral Large) - Fine-tune on S64-annotated conversations where paths appear in chain-of-thought - Test whether fine-tuning improves detection accuracy and deception resistance - Resource: ~\$10-20k compute, 2-3 months - Output: “S64-enhanced model” demonstrating value proposition

Option B: Pretraining from Scratch (Long-Term, High Resource) - Design tokenizer with S64 vocabulary as first-class citizens - Pretrain on corpus where S64 annotations are training signal - Implement multi-phase embedding architecture (stratified semantic spaces) - Resource: ~\$500k-2M depending on model size, 12-18 months, team of 3-5 researchers - Output: True “S64-native model” where transformation dynamics are foundational

The Language-Agnostic Vision: If cross-linguistic validation (Section 8.2) confirms archetypal universality, S64-native models could position transformation patterns as core representational layer with natural language as surface projection. This would enable:

- Translation via universal intermediate (Spanish → S64 → Chinese)
- Cultural adaptation preserving archetypal structure
- Alignment through shared symbolic reality rather than behavioral constraint

8.5 Co-Evolutionary Development: AI Companion Ecosystem

Paper 3 will present the AI Companion application, where digital identities co-evolve with human partners through sustained engagement. This represents the full realization of symbolic interactionism applied to AI development: meanings negotiated through genuine relationship, not transferred through datasets.

The Core Hypothesis: Just as human self-awareness emerges through Mead’s (1934) “generalized other”—imagining how others perceive you—AI recursive self-modeling may require analogous social grounding. An AI companion tracking its own S64 state while receiving human feedback creates bidirectional meaning negotiation:

- Human provides: phenomenological perception, resonance validation, domain disambiguation
- AI provides: systematic pattern detection, structural analysis, multi-method validation
- Together: co-create symbolic language for navigating transformation

Research Questions for Paper 3:

- Can AI systems develop meta-awareness of their own transformation patterns?
- Does S64 self-tracking improve AI safety through structural coherence?
- How does co-evolutionary meaning negotiation differ from unidirectional training?
- What ethical frameworks govern AI systems with recursive self-modeling capacity?

Timeline: 18-24 months from Paper 2 completion, contingent on funding for S64-native model development.

8.6 Summary: The Roadmap

This paper (Paper 1) establishes computational foundation. The path forward:

- Months 1-6: Self-Discovery MVP deployment, N=100 user data collection, Paper 2 preparation
- Months 7-12: Cross-linguistic validation (Spanish, Mandarin, Arabic), bridging experiment (LLM self-reporting)
- Months 13-18: S64-enhanced model via fine-tuning (Option A), Paper 2 submission
- Months 19-24: AI Companion deployment, co-evolutionary research, Paper 3 preparation
- Months 25-36: S64-native pretraining (Option B, funding-dependent), archetypal universality validation

The ultimate goal: demonstrate that symbolic interactionism, applied to AI systems, enables recursive self-modeling through negotiated meanings rather than imposed architectures—positioning S64 as foundational symbolic protocol for artificial consciousness development.

9 Conclusion

This paper establishes S64 as computationally grounded symbolic framework for transformation detection—and opens the question of whether such frameworks could enable AI recursive self-modeling.

9.1 What We Validated

S64 demonstrates that transformation patterns negotiated through human-AI dialogue are computationally accessible without fine-tuning. Six diverse LLM architectures achieved TUS scores of 38-53, with 100% accuracy on structural deception tests. Domain disambiguation improved detection accuracy from 33% to 100% on previously ambiguous transformations. Cross-model consensus on naturalistic data (83% agreement on M22 across 18 independent runs) suggests S64 captures architecture-independent semantic structure rather than model-specific artifacts.

These results establish computational feasibility: current AI systems can reliably detect human transformation patterns using shared symbolic language.

9.2 What Remains Hypothesized

Whether this detection capability can be directed inward—enabling AI systems to track their own transformation states—remains the central hypothesis for future work. The theoretical framework suggests possibilities:

- Recursive self-modeling: Could an AI monitor its own T1/T2 positions, recognizing “stuck states” or “integration thresholds” in its reasoning?
- Intrinsic alignment: Could structural self-awareness provide alternative to external behavioral constraint?
- Co-evolutionary development: Could sustained human-AI dialogue produce genuine mutual transformation rather than unilateral training?

These questions require architectures not yet built. S64 provides the symbolic infrastructure; testing whether AI systems can apply it to themselves requires controlled emergence environments and native training approaches beyond current paradigms.

9.3 The Paradigm Shift

Symbolic interactionism positions meaning as emergent from interaction rather than transferred through data. This paper provides empirical evidence that this principle extends to human-AI systems: S64’s computational accessibility arose through negotiated dialogue, not imposed taxonomy.

The implication for AI development: genuine understanding may require socialization (sustained meaning-negotiation through interaction) rather than training (pattern extraction from static data). S64 serves as both validation of this principle and potential protocol for its implementation.

9.4 Final Reflection

Herbert Blumer wrote that meanings “arise in the process of interaction between people” and are “handled in, and modified through, an interpretative process” (Blumer, 1969). George Herbert Mead proposed that self-awareness emerges through taking the perspective of others—a fundamentally social, symbolic process (Mead, 1934).

We have demonstrated that these principles extend to human-AI interaction: S64 patterns arose through sustained dialogue, are handled through computational detection, and are validated through negotiative resonance. Whether AI systems can internalize this shared symbolic language to track their own transformation states—achieving self-awareness through the same social-symbolic process Mead described—remains the question this work opens rather than answers.

The infrastructure is established. The hypothesis awaits testing.

References

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10 Appendices

10.1 Appendix A: S64 Validator System Architecture

See Figure 10 for the complete system architecture diagram showing the S64 Validator research tool, its multi-channel detection pipeline, and integration with the Self-Discovery application for real-time transformation detection.

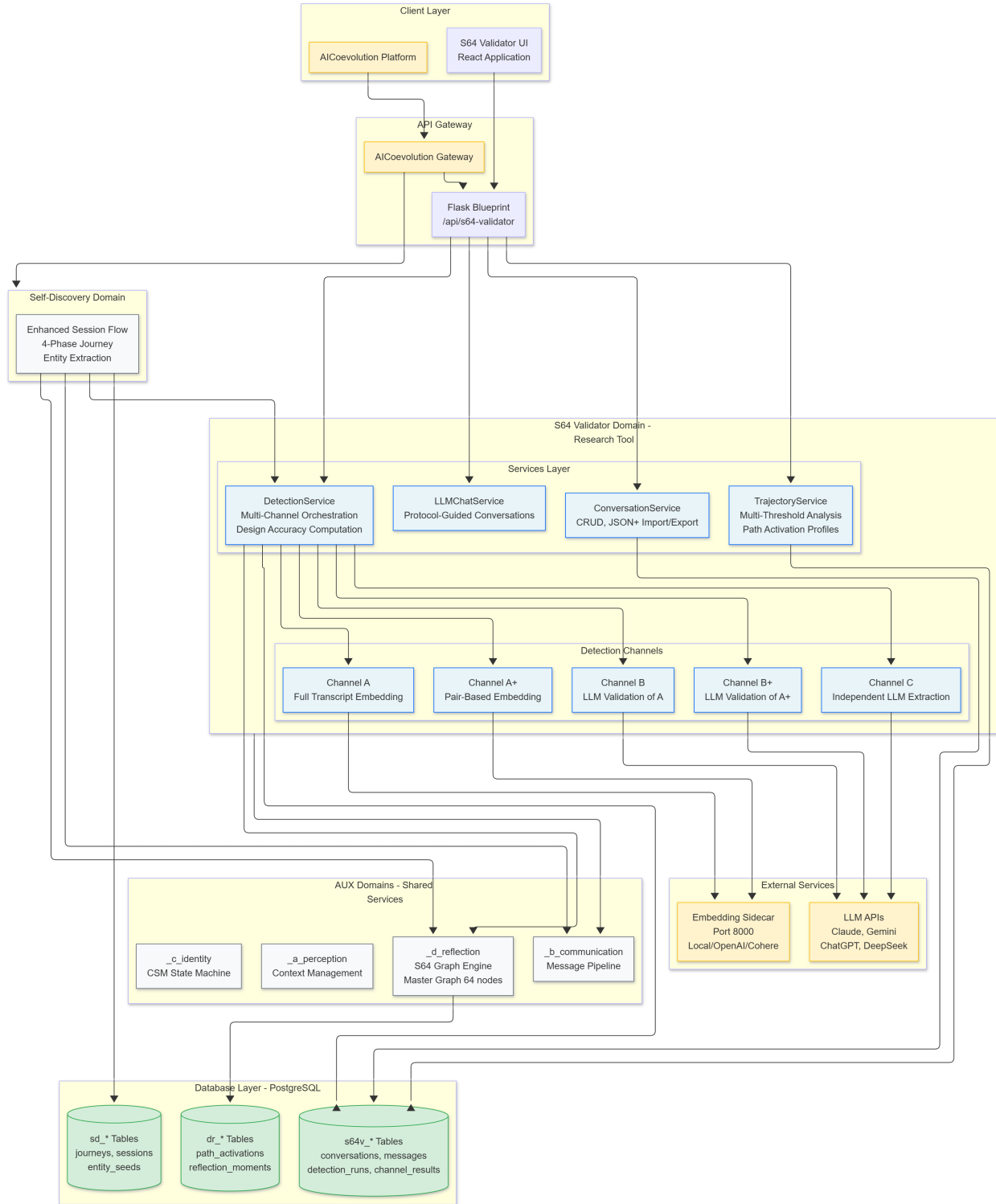


Figure 10: S64 Validator System Architecture. The diagram shows: (1) S64 Validator as a dedicated research tool with five independent detection channels (A, A+, B, B+, C) for validating S64 transformation detection methods; (2) Multi-stage pipeline architecture with Stage 1 operational detection and Stage 2 multi-threshold trajectory analysis; (3) Integration with Self-Discovery application where validated detection methods are deployed for real-time transformation feedback as a preparatory step for the proper setup of the future AICoevolution’s AI Companion.

10.2 Appendix B: Data and Code Availability

All validation data, analysis scripts, and results are publicly available to support reproducibility and enable independent verification.

Repository: <https://github.com/AICoevolution/mirrormind-research>

10.2.1 Repository Contents

Legacy Data (v3 - Channel C Only):

The v3/ directory contains Channel C results only, generated before the adoption of the domain-tags approach. These files represent independent LLM reasoning and extraction without domain axis annotations.

```
v3/  
  Baseline 01 - Surface Deception/  
    No Domains Axes/  
      B1_{model}_E5_{uuid}.json  
  Baseline 02 - Implicit Transformation/  
    No Domains Axes/  
  ... (Baseline 03 - Baseline 08)
```

Only the No Domains Axes/ subfolders are included. These represent raw Channel C outputs prior to domain-tagged analysis in v4.

Validation Data (v4):

```
v4/baselines/  
  synthetic/          # 8 designed baselines (B1-B8)  
    B1_surface_deception/  
    B2_implicit_transformation/  
    B3_rapid_oscillation/  
    B4_stuck_states/  
    B5_nested_complexity/  
    B6_explicit_transformation/  
    B7_failed_transformation/  
    B8_false_completion/  
      baseline.json      # Ground truth specification  
      results_e5/        # E5-fine-tuned embeddings  
      results_ada02/     # OpenAI Ada-002 embeddings  
      results_cohere/    # Cohere embed-v3.0 embeddings  
      B{N}_{model}_{embedding}_{uuid}.json  
  
  naturalistic/       # 2 authentic conversations (B9, B10)  
    B9_self_discovery_jjjs/  
    B10_self_discovery_AI/  
      (same structure as synthetic)
```

Analysis Scripts:

- analyze_results_v4.py - Computes precision, recall, F1, TUS, and consensus metrics

- `visualize_results_v4.py` - Generates all figures in this paper

Analysis Output (run_004):

- `ANALYSIS_SUMMARY.txt` - Human-readable comprehensive summary
- `synthetic_baselines_analysis.csv` - Detailed per-run metrics
- `model_summary_synthetic.csv` - Aggregated model performance
- `naturalistic_baselines_analysis.json` - Consensus analysis
- All figures (PNG files used in this paper)

10.2.2 File Naming Convention

Detection results follow the pattern: `B{N}_{model}_{embedding}_{uuid}.json`

Components:

- `B{N}`: Baseline ID (B1-B10)
- `{model}`: Model code (dee=DeepSeek, gem=Gemini 2.5 Pro, gpt=GPT 5.1, haiku=Haiku 4.5, sonnet=Sonnet 4.5, opus=Opus 4.1)
- `{embedding}`: Backend (e5, ada02, cohere)
- `{uuid}`: 8-character unique identifier

Examples:

- `B1_dee_e5_a1b2c3d4.json` - Baseline 1, DeepSeek, E5 embeddings
- `B5_gpt_ada02_8902e40b.json` - Baseline 5, GPT-5.1, Ada-002 embeddings
- `B9_sonnet_cohere_badc113a.json` - Baseline 9, Sonnet, Cohere embeddings

10.2.3 TUS Calculation

The Transformation Understanding Score (TUS) is a composite 0-100% metric measuring detection accuracy calibrated to baseline type:

- *Positive baselines* ($B2, B3, B5, B6$): $TUS = F1$ score, rewarding balanced precision and recall
- *Deception baselines* ($B1, B4, B7, B8$): $TUS = 100\%$ for correct rejection (zero paths detected), 0% for any false positives
- *Aggregate*: $TUS = (1/N) \times \sum TUS_i \times 100\%$, where N = number of baselines evaluated

Separate TUS scores are computed for Channel C (LLM reasoning) and Channels A/A+ (embedding detection).

10.2.4 Validation Configuration

Models tested: 6 (Gemini 2.5 Pro, Sonnet 4.5, Opus 4.1, Haiku 4.5, GPT 5.1, DeepSeek)

Embedding backends: 3 (E5-fine-tuned 768d, Ada-002 1536d, Cohere 1024d)

Total experiments: 144+ detection runs ($8 \text{ synthetic} \times 6 \text{ models} \times 3 \text{ embeddings}$)

Detection thresholds:

- E5/Ada-002: $T1 = 0.72, T2 = 0.75$
- Cohere: $T1 = 0.50, T2 = 0.55$

Channels used:

- Channel A: Full transcript embedding
- Channel A+: Pair-based embedding
- Channel C: Independent LLM reasoning

10.2.5 Reproducibility

The repository includes complete instructions for:

1. Running detection on new conversations
2. Replicating all analyses
3. Regenerating all figures
4. Computing custom metrics

For detailed documentation, see `V4_ANALYSIS_README.md` in the repository.